

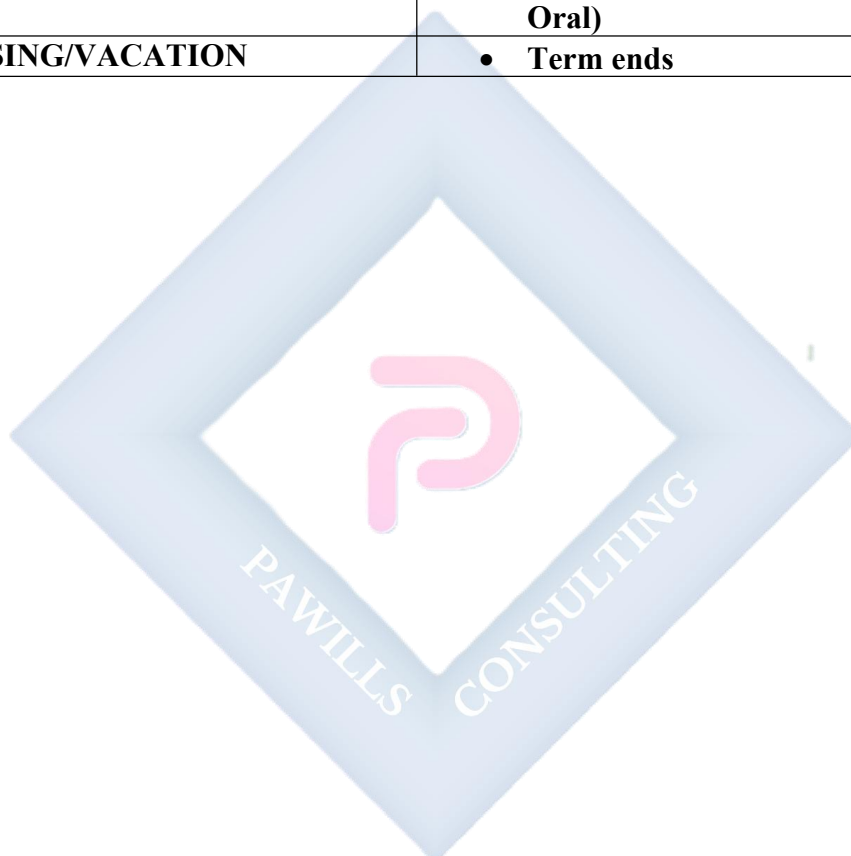
PRIMARY 4 ENGLISH LANGUAGE SCHEME OF WORK

FIRST TERM

Week	Topic	Breakdown (Subtopics)
1	Conversations/Dialogues Using Modal Auxiliaries (Part 1)	• Meaning and uses of modal auxiliaries • Modal auxiliaries: can/could (ability, permission, possibility) • Examples: "I can swim", "Could you help me?" • Modal auxiliaries: will/would (future actions, polite requests) • Examples: "I will come tomorrow", "Would you like some water?" • Practice dialogues using can/could and will/would
2	Conversations/Dialogues Using Modal Auxiliaries (Part 2)	• Modal auxiliaries: shall/should (suggestions, obligations, advice) • Examples: "Shall we go?", "You should study hard" • Modal auxiliaries: may/might (permission, possibility) • Examples: "May I go out?", "It might rain today" • Observing conversation etiquette: turn-taking, listening, politeness • Practice dialogues using shall/should and may/might
3	Conversations/Dialogues Using Modal Auxiliaries (Part 3)	• Modal auxiliaries: must, ought to (strong obligation, necessity) • Examples: "You must obey your parents", "We ought to be grateful" • Modal auxiliaries: need to, used to, dare • Examples: "I need to finish my homework", "I used to live in Lagos", "How dare you!" • Engaging in conversations on national values using modal auxiliaries • Group dialogues and role-play activities
4	Conversations/Dialogues Using Modal Auxiliaries (Part 4)	• Creating conversations on various topics using modal auxiliaries: • Insecurity: "We should report suspicious activities" • Financial system: "We must save money for the future"

		• Corruption: "Leaders ought to be honest" • Observing conversation etiquette in group discussions • Class debates using modal auxiliaries • Assessment of modal auxiliary usage
5	MID-TERM EXAMINATION	• Assessment of Weeks 1-4
6	MID-TERM BREAK	• Holiday/Rest
7	Aural Discrimination in Vowels	• Discriminating between the sounds /ʌ/ and /ɜ:/ in words • Practice words: • cup/curb, luck/lurk, gull/girl, bust/burst • Listening exercises to identify sounds • Pronunciation practice • Using words in sentences • Spelling activities with these sound patterns
8	Aural Discrimination in Consonants	• Discriminating between pairs of consonants /tʃ/ and /ʃ/ • Practice words: chin/shin, chop/shop, catch/cash • Discriminating between /v/ and /f/ • Practice words: vest/first, very/ferry, have/half • Distinguishing between voiced and voiceless consonant sounds • Pronunciation drills and listening activities
9	Homophones and Homographs (Part 1)	• Understanding homophones: words that sound the same but have different meanings • Examples and practice: • to/too/two, their/there/they're • bare/bear, fair/fare, knight/night • Using homophones correctly in sentences • Spelling practice with homophones • Context clues to determine correct homophone
10	Homophones and Homographs (Part 2)	• Understanding homographs: words with same spelling but different meanings • Examples and practice: • bank (financial institution) / bank (riverbank) • bat (animal) / bat (sports equipment)

		• spring (season) / spring (coiled metal object) • Using context to understand homograph meanings • Creating sentences with homographs • Homophone and homograph games and exercises
11	REVISION	• Review: Modal auxiliaries, aural discrimination, homophones, homographs
12	EXAMINATION	• End of Term Assessment (Written and Oral)
13	CLOSING/VACATION	• Term ends



PRIMARY 4 ENGLISH LANGUAGE LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: CONVERSATIONS/DIALOGUES USING MODAL AUXILIARIES (PART 1)

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define modal auxiliaries.
2. Identify the modal auxiliaries "can/could" and "will/would" in sentences.
3. Use "can" and "could" to express ability, permission, and possibility in simple conversations.
4. Use "will" and "would" to express future actions and polite requests in simple conversations.

CONTENT



Meaning of Modal Auxiliaries

Modal auxiliaries are special helper verbs. They cannot work alone; they must join with a main verb. Think of them as helpers that add special meaning to an action. They tell us about ability

(what we are able to do), permission (if we are allowed to do something), possibility (if something might happen), or future plans. Using them helps us speak politely and clearly.

- **Main Verb:** The action word (e.g., swim, go, play).
- **Modal Auxiliary:** The helper that adds meaning (e.g., can, will).

Using Can and Could

- **Can:** We use "can" to talk about what someone is able to do *now* or to ask for permission in a friendly, informal way.
 - *Ability (Now):* "I **can** swim." (This means I know how to swim. I have this ability now).
 - *Informal Permission:* "**Can** I drink water?" (This is asking a friend or family member if it is okay).
- **Could:** "Could" is often the past form of "can," but we also use it to be very polite, especially when talking to elders, teachers, or people we respect.
 - *Past Ability:* "When I was small, I **could** not tie my shoelaces." (In the past, I did not have that ability).
 - *Polite Request:* "**Could** you please help me, Ma?" (This is more polite and respectful than saying "Can you help me?").

Using Will and Would

- **Will:** We use "will" to talk about something that has not happened yet but will happen later (future). We also use it to make a promise.
 - *Future Action:* "I **will** visit my grandma **tomorrow**." (The visit is planned for later).
 - *Promise:* "I **will** finish my homework." (This is like giving your word).
- **Would:** "Would" is often the past form of "will," but we mostly use it for very polite offers or invitations.

- *Polite Offer*: "**Would** you like some biscuits?" (A very nice way to offer something).
- *Polite Request*: "**Would** you mind passing my book?" (A very respectful way to ask for help).

Practice Dialogue

- **Ali**: Can you ride a bicycle? (*Asking about ability*)
- **Bisi**: Yes, I **can**. I **will** ride with you after school. (*Shows ability and future plan*)
- **Ali**: Great! **Could** you help me learn? (*Polite request*)
- **Bisi**: Yes, I **would** be happy to help. (*Polite offer*)

EVALUATION

1. What are modal auxiliaries? (Helper verbs that join with main verbs).
2. Make a sentence using "can" to show you are able to do something.
3. Change this command to a polite request using "could": "Give me the chalk."
4. Make a sentence using "will" to talk about what you will do this weekend.
5. Which word is better for offering food to a visitor: "Will you like food?" or "Would you like food?" (Circle the correct one).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written)**: Write two sentences about things you **can** do and one sentence about something you **could not** do when you were younger.
2. **(Oral & Practical)**: At home, politely ask a family member for something using "Could you please...?" Tell the class about it tomorrow.
3. **(Written)**: Fill in the gaps with **can**, **could**, **will**, or **would**:
 - "_____ I borrow your pencil?"
 - "She _____ read a story to us later."
 - "_____ you like to join our game?"

WEEK 2: CONVERSATIONS/DIALOGUES USING MODAL AUXILIARIES (PART 2)

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Use "shall" and "should" to make suggestions and give advice.
2. Use "may" and "might" to ask for permission and express possibility.
3. Demonstrate proper conversation etiquette (listening and waiting for turns).
4. Construct a simple dialogue using these modal auxiliaries.

CONTENT



Using Shall and Should

- **Shall:** We often use "shall" with "I" and "we" to make a friendly suggestion or a kind offer. It sounds more formal and polite than "should".
 - *Suggestion:* "**Shall** we clean the classroom together?" (This is a polite way to suggest doing something as a group).
 - *Offer:* "**Shall** I help you carry your bag?" (This is a kind offer to help someone).

- **Should:** We use "should" to give good advice or to talk about what is the right or sensible thing to do.
 - *Advice:* "You have a test. You **should** study your notes." (This is a good idea).
 - *Right Thing to Do:* "We **should** listen when the teacher is talking." (This is the correct behaviour).

Using May and Might

- **May:** We use "may" to ask for permission in a very respectful way, especially from elders or teachers. We also use it to say something is possible and likely.
 - *Formal Permission:* "**May** I go to the toilet, Sir?" (A very polite way to ask).
 - *Strong Possibility:* "Look at the dark clouds. It **may** rain soon." (It is very possible).
- **Might:** We use "might" to say something is possible, but we are less sure about it than when we use "may".
 - *Weak Possibility:* "I finished my work early. I **might** go to the playground later." (I am not sure yet, but it is possible).

Conversation Etiquette (Good Talking Manners)

When we talk with others, we must be polite and respectful.

- **Turn-taking:** Wait for the other person to finish speaking before you talk. Do not interrupt.
- **Good Listening:** Look at the person who is speaking. Listen carefully to understand them.
- **Polite Words:** Using words like "May I...?", "Could you...?", and "Please" shows respect.

Practice Dialogue

- **Teacher:** Shall we read this story? (*Polite suggestion*)
- **Pupil:** Yes, Ma. **May** I read the first page? (*Polite request for permission*)

- **Teacher:** Yes, you **may**. You **should** read clearly so everyone can hear. (*Giving permission and advice*)

EVALUATION

1. Which modal auxiliary do we use to give advice to a friend? (Should/Shall).
2. Ask for permission to drink water using "May."
3. Make a sentence using "might" to show you are not sure about going to the market.
4. Fill in the blank: "Pupils _____ raise their hand before speaking." (should/might).
5. Why is it important to wait for your turn in a conversation?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Write two pieces of advice for a new pupil in Primary 4, using "should." (e.g., "You should bring your textbook.")
2. **(Oral & Practical):** Role-play with a friend: One asks for permission to borrow a book using "May I...?" and the other replies.
3. **(Written):** Complete the sentences:
 - "We _____ visit the zoo on Saturday if Daddy agrees." (may/might)
 - "_____ I offer you a seat?" (Shall/Should)

WEEK 3: CONVERSATIONS/DIALOGUES USING MODAL AUXILIARIES (PART 3)

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Use "must" and "ought to" to express strong obligation and necessity.
2. Identify and use "need to," "used to," and "dare" in sentences.
3. Engage in a conversation about national values using appropriate modal verbs.

CONTENT



Using Must and Ought To

- **Must:** This shows a very strong rule, necessity, or something that is very important with no choice. It is like a strong command.
 - *Strong Rule:* "You **must** wear your uniform to school." (This is a school rule; you have to do it).
 - *Strong Necessity:* "I **must** drink water because I am very thirsty." (It is very necessary).

- **Ought to:** This is similar to "should" but feels stronger, like a duty or the right thing to do for moral reasons. It talks about what is good and proper.
 - *Moral Duty:* "We **ought to** tell the truth." (This is the right thing to do).
 - *Moral Duty:* "We **ought to** help our parents at home." (It is our duty as good children).

Using Need to, Used to, and Dare

- **Need to:** This expresses something that is necessary or important to do.
 - *Example:* "I **need to** wear shoes to protect my feet." (It is important for safety).
- **Used to:** This talks about a habit or something that happened regularly in the past but does not happen now.
 - *Example:* "I **used to** be afraid of the dark." (In the past I was afraid, but now I am not).
- **Dare:** This is used to challenge someone or to talk about having courage (bravery). It is often used in questions or with 'not'.
 - *Challenge:* "How **dare** you talk back to your mother!" (Showing shock at someone's boldness).
 - *Lack of Courage:* "I **dare not** touch the hot stove." (I am too afraid/scared to do it).

Conversation on National Values (Being a Good Citizen)

We can use these modals to talk about how to be good citizens of Nigeria:

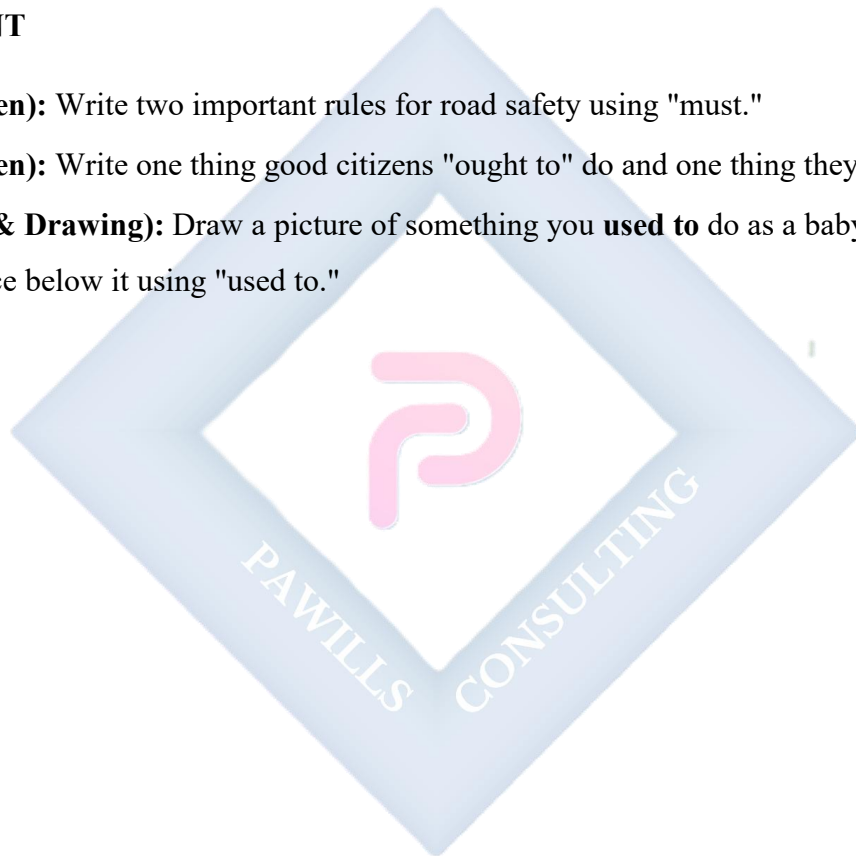
- "We **must** obey the law."
- "We **ought to** respect our National Flag."
- "We **need to** keep our environment clean by not littering."
- "I **used to** throw wrappers on the ground, but now I use the bin."

EVALUATION

1. Make a sentence using "must" to state a very important school rule.
2. What is the difference? "I **need to** eat" vs. "I **used to** eat mangoes every day."
3. Complete: "We _____ be kind to others." (ought to/dare).
4. Make a sentence with "used to" about a game you played in Primary 1.
5. In the sentence "I dare you to jump," what is the speaker doing? (Giving a challenge/Asking for permission).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Write two important rules for road safety using "must."
2. **(Written):** Write one thing good citizens "ought to" do and one thing they "need to" do.
3. **(Oral & Drawing):** Draw a picture of something you **used to** do as a baby. Write one sentence below it using "used to."



WEEK 4: CONVERSATIONS/DIALOGUES USING MODAL AUXILIARIES (PART 4)

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Create conversations on specific topics (Insecurity, Finance, Corruption) using modal auxiliaries.
2. Use modal verbs to suggest solutions to problems.
3. Participate in a class debate or group discussion observing proper etiquette.

CONTENT



Creating Conversations on Important Topics We can use all the modal verbs to talk about important issues in a polite and thoughtful way.

Topic 1: Safety (Insecurity)

- *Suggestion:* "We **should** always walk home in groups."
- *Ability:* "Security guards **can** help keep our school safe."
- *Necessity:* "We **must** tell our parents or teachers if we see anything strange."

Topic 2: Money (Finance)

- *Advice:* "You **ought to** save some money in your piggy bank."

- *Future Plan*: "If I save my transport fare, I **will** buy a new notebook."
- *Necessity*: "We **need to** understand that money does not grow on trees."

Topic 3: Honesty (Fighting Corruption)

- *Strong Rule*: "Leaders **must** use public money for the public."
- *Possibility*: "If everyone is honest, our country **might** develop faster."
- *Courage*: "We **must not dare** to take what does not belong to us."

Group Activity: Class Debate A debate is a discussion where people talk about different sides of a topic.

- **Topic**: "Pupils **should** help with chores at home."
- **Group A (For)**: "Helping at home teaches responsibility. We **ought to** help our parents."
- **Group B (Against)**: "We **need to** have time to rest and study. Chores **can** be too much."

Debate Etiquette:

- Listen when others speak.
- Wait for your turn.
- Speak politely. Say "I disagree because..." not "You are wrong!"

EVALUATION

1. Give one safety tip for walking to school using "should."
2. Make a sentence about saving money using "will."
3. What modal verb shows a strong duty for leaders to be honest? (must/ought to).
4. In a debate, how can you politely say you have a different opinion?
5. Create a sentence about fighting corruption using "might."

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written)**: Write a short 4-line dialogue between two friends. One suggests saving money for a football, and the other agrees. Use "should" and "will."
2. **(Written)**: Write two rules for staying safe online using "must" and "should."

3. **(Oral & Practical):** In a group, discuss one thing the government **ought to** do to make your school better. Report one idea to the class.



WEEK 5: MID-TERM EXAMINATION

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Attempt questions covering topics from Week 1 to Week 4 correctly.

CONTENT

- **Assessment:** The teacher will administer a written test covering all modal auxiliaries taught (can, could, will, would, shall, should, may, might, must, ought to, need to, used to). Questions will include filling in gaps, making sentences, and choosing the correct polite request.

EVALUATION

- Grading and corrections.

ASSIGNMENT

- Review all test corrections.

WEEK 6: MID-TERM BREAK



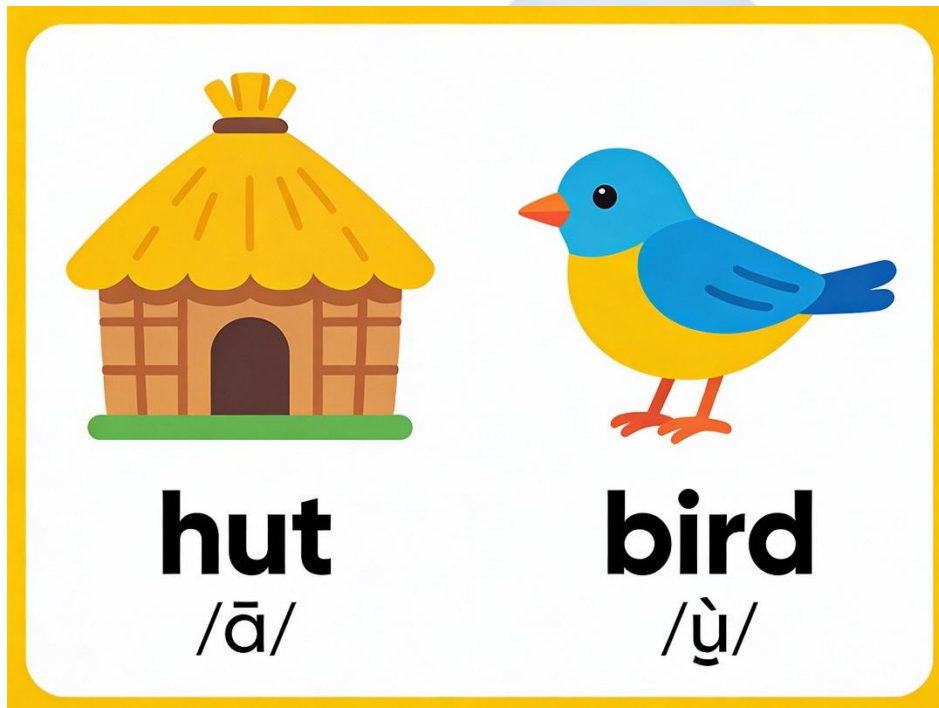
WEEK 7: AURAL DISCRIMINATION IN VOWELS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify the vowel sounds /ʌ/ (as in 'cup') and /ɜ:/ (as in 'girl').
2. Distinguish between words containing /ʌ/ and /ɜ:/ by listening.
3. Pronounce words with these sounds correctly.
4. Use the words in simple sentences.

CONTENT



The Sound /ʌ/ (Short Sound) This is a short, quick vowel sound. Your mouth is relaxed and open a little. It sounds like "uh". We often find it in words with the letter 'u' or 'o'.

- *Examples:* up, cut, luck, money, love, son.
 - Imagine you are surprised: "Uh! What is that?"

The Sound /ɜ:/ (Long Sound) This is a long vowel sound. Your tongue is in the middle of your mouth, and you make a longer, deeper sound. We often find it in words with 'ir', 'ur', 'er', or 'ear'.

- *Examples:* girl, shirt, **curb**, turn, her, learn, heard.
 - Imagine you are thinking deeply: "Hmm..."

Listening and Saying Pairs of Words Listen and say the difference. The first is short (/ʌ/), the second is long (/ɜ:/).

Short Sound /ʌ/ (like "uh")	Long Sound /ɜ:/ (like "err")
cup (for tea)	curb (side of road)
luck (good fortune)	lurk (to hide)
hut (small house)	hurt (to feel pain)
bud (on a flower)	bird (animal that flies)

Listening Exercise The teacher will say a word. Pupils will clap once for the short /ʌ/ sound and clap twice for the long /ɜ:/ sound.

EVALUATION

1. Say the word "shirt." Is the vowel sound short or long?
2. Which word has the /ʌ/ sound: "hurt" or "hut"?
3. Pronounce this pair: "bug" and "burg."
4. Write two words that have the long /ɜ:/ sound.
5. Make a simple sentence with the word "bird."

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Find and write three words in your storybook that have the short /ʌ/ sound (like 'cup').
2. **(Written):** Find and write three words in your storybook that have the long /ɜ:/ sound (like 'girl').
3. **(Oral & Drawing):** Draw a small **hut** and a flying **bird**. Label your drawings.

WEEK 8: AURAL DISCRIMINATION IN CONSONANTS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Distinguish between the consonant sounds /tʃ/ ('ch') and /ʃ/ ('sh').
2. Distinguish between the consonant sounds /v/ and /f/.
3. Pronounce word pairs containing these sounds clearly.
4. Identify voiced and voiceless consonants in the pairs.

CONTENT

CH vs SH

chin /tʃn/

ship /ʃp/

F vs V

fan /fæn/

van /væn/

Sound Pair 1: /tʃ/ vs /ʃ/

- **/tʃ/ (the 'CH' sound):** This is a sharp, quick sound. Put your tongue to the roof of your mouth and release air. It sounds like a train: "**Ch- Ch- Ch!**"
 - *Examples:* **Chin, chop, catch, chew, teacher.**
- **/ʃ/ (the 'SH' sound):** This is a soft, quiet, rushing sound. Push air out between your teeth. It sounds like telling someone to be quiet: "**Shhhh!**"
 - *Examples:* **Shin, shop, fish, shoe, wash.**

Say These Pairs:

- **Chin** (on your face) --- **Shin** (on your leg)
- **Chew** your food --- Wear a **shoe**
- **Chips** to eat --- **Ships** on the sea

Sound Pair 2: /f/ vs /v/

- **/f/ (Voiceless 'F'):** Bite your lower lip gently and blow air out. **Do not** use your voice box. Feel the air on your hand. No vibration in your throat.
 - *Examples:* Fan, fine, leaf, giraffe.
- **/v/ (Voiced 'V'):** Do the same as /f/, but **add your voice**. Your throat should vibrate. Touch your throat as you say "vvvvv" to feel the buzz.
 - *Examples:* Van, vine, leave, wave.

Say These Pairs:

- A **fan** cools you --- A **van** carries people
- Feel the **feather** --- Peel the **vegetable**
- Be **safe** --- Save money

EVALUATION

1. Pronounce the difference between "ship" and "chip."
2. Place your hand on your throat. Which sound makes it vibrate: /f/ or /v/?
3. Is the 'sh' in "shop" a sharp sound or a soft, rushing sound?
4. Circle the word that starts with the /f/ sound: (Chair, Share).
5. Use "fan" and "van" in one sentence.

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Draw two columns. List three things you can **chew** and three things you can **share**.

2. **(Practical):** At home, find one object whose name starts with 'f' (e.g., fork) and one with 'v' (e.g., vase). Say their names, feeling your throat.
3. **(Oral):** Practice this tongue twister slowly: "She sells shiny shells."



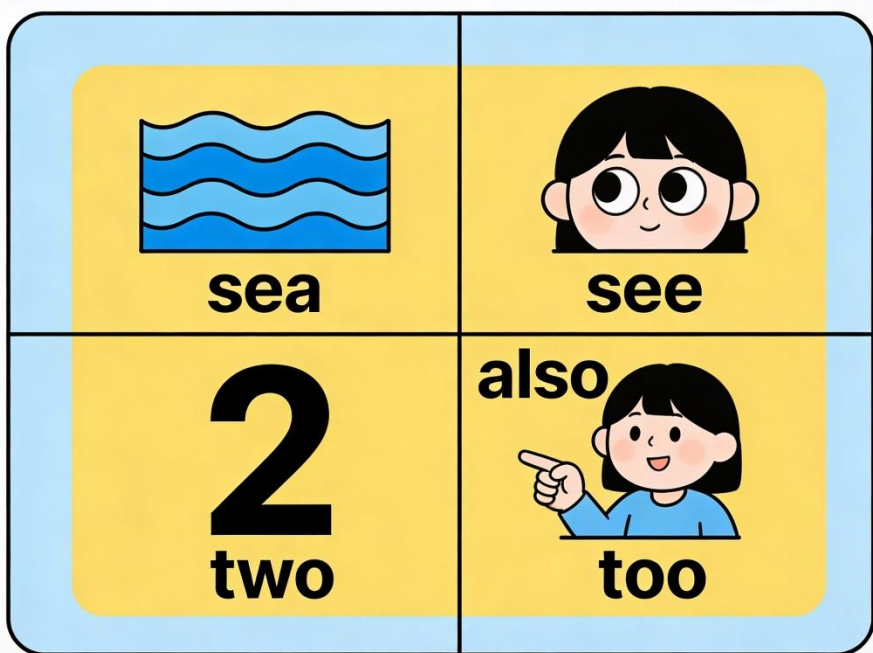
WEEK 9: HOMOPHONES AND HOMOGRAPHHS (PART 1)

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define Homophones.
2. Identify common homophones.
3. Differentiate the meanings of homophones based on spelling.
4. Use correct homophones in sentences.

CONTENT



Understanding Homophones

Homophones are words that **sound the same** when you say them but have **different spellings and different meanings**.

- *Homo* = same, *phone* = sound.
- **Example:** "I can see the boat on the sea." (See and sea sound alike).

Common Homophone Pairs:

Sound-alike Words	Meaning & Example
To	Used for direction. "I go to school."
Too	Means "also" or "very." "I am hungry too ." / "It is too hot."
Two	The number 2. "I have two hands."
There	Talks about a place. "Your book is over there ."
Their	Shows ownership. "That is their house."
They're	Short for "They are." " They're my friends."
Bare	Means empty or uncovered. " Bare feet."
Bear	A large animal. "The bear is brown."
Knight	A warrior in old times.
Night	The dark time after sunset.

Using Clues in the Sentence (Context) To know which spelling to use, think about the meaning of the whole sentence.

- "I have a red (pare/pair/pear)." You eat a fruit, so it's **pear**.
- "I have a (pare/pair/pear) of socks." Socks come in twos, so it's **pair**.

EVALUATION

1. What are homophones? (Words that sound the same but have different spellings and meanings).
2. Choose the correct word: "My (sun/son) is in Primary 2."
3. Choose the correct word: "The (see/sea) water is blue."
4. Make a sentence with "write" (to use a pen) and "right" (correct direction).
5. Spell the homophone for "eight" (the number) and "ate" (past of eat).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Draw a picture for each word: a **flower** and something that **flour** (ingredient) is used to make, like bread.
2. **(Written):** Fill in the gaps:

- "I want _____ go _____ the market." (to, too, two)
 - "_____ going to _____ house." (There, Their, They're)
3. **(Oral):** Tell a partner a sentence using "blue" (colour) and another using "blew" (past of blow).



WEEK 10: HOMOPHONES AND HOMOGRAPHS (PART 2)

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define Homographs.
2. Identify words that are spelled the same but have different meanings.
3. Use context to determine the meaning of a homograph.
4. Construct sentences showing different meanings of the same word.

CONTENT

bat  bat (animal: a nocturnal flying mammal)	 bat (sports: a club used in baseball)
bank  bank (money: a financial institution)	 bank (river: the edge of a river)

Understanding Homographs

Homographs are words that are **spelled the same** but have **different meanings** (and sometimes different pronunciations).

- *Homo* = same, *graph* = writing.
- **Example:** "I **watch** TV every day." vs. "My **watch** tells the time." (Same spelling, different meanings).

Common Homographs:

Word	Meaning 1	Meaning 2
Bank	Place to keep money. "I went to the bank ."	Side of a river. "We sat on the river bank ."
Bat	A flying animal. "A bat sleeps during the day."	Sports equipment. "He hit the ball with a bat ."
Bow	(/baʊ/) To bend forward. " Bow to greet."	(/boʊ/) A ribbon. "She has a bow in her hair."
Well	In good health. "I am well ."	A deep hole for water. "Fetch water from the well ."
Watch	To look at. " Watch the road."	A clock on wrist. "My watch is new."

Using Context Clues The other words in the sentence tell you which meaning is being used.

- "The **leaves** on the tree are green." (Here, 'leaves' means parts of a tree).
- "My father **leaves** for work at 7 am." (Here, 'leaves' means goes away).

EVALUATION

1. What are homographs? (Words spelled the same but with different meanings).
2. Give two meanings for "bark." (Dog's sound / Tree covering).
3. Give two meanings for "ring." (Jewelry / Sound of a bell).
4. Use "play" in two sentences with different meanings (e.g., to play a game, to watch a play).
5. Is "bat" (animal) spelled the same as "bat" (sports stick)? (Yes/No).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Drawing & Writing):** Draw two pictures for the word "mouse": a computer mouse and an animal mouse. Write a sentence for each.
2. **(Written):** Write one sentence for each meaning of "park": (1) a garden, (2) to stop a car.
3. **(Oral):** Explain the two meanings of "ruler" to your friend: (1) a king/leader, (2) a tool for measuring.

WEEK 11: REVISION

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Recall key concepts from the entire term.
2. Answer questions on modal auxiliaries, sounds, homophones, and homographs correctly.

CONTENT

Comprehensive Review

- **Grammar:** When do we use **can** vs **could**? **Will** vs **would**? **Must** vs **should**?
- **Sounds:** What is the difference between the short /ʌ/ (cup) and long /ɜ:/ (girl) sound?
How do /f/ and /v/ feel in your throat?
- **Vocabulary:**
 - **Homophones:** Sound same, spell different (see/sea).
 - **Homographs:** Spell same, mean different (bank/bank).

EVALUATION

- Oral quizzes and written revision exercises covering the term's work.

ASSIGNMENT

- Study all notes for the end-of-term examination.
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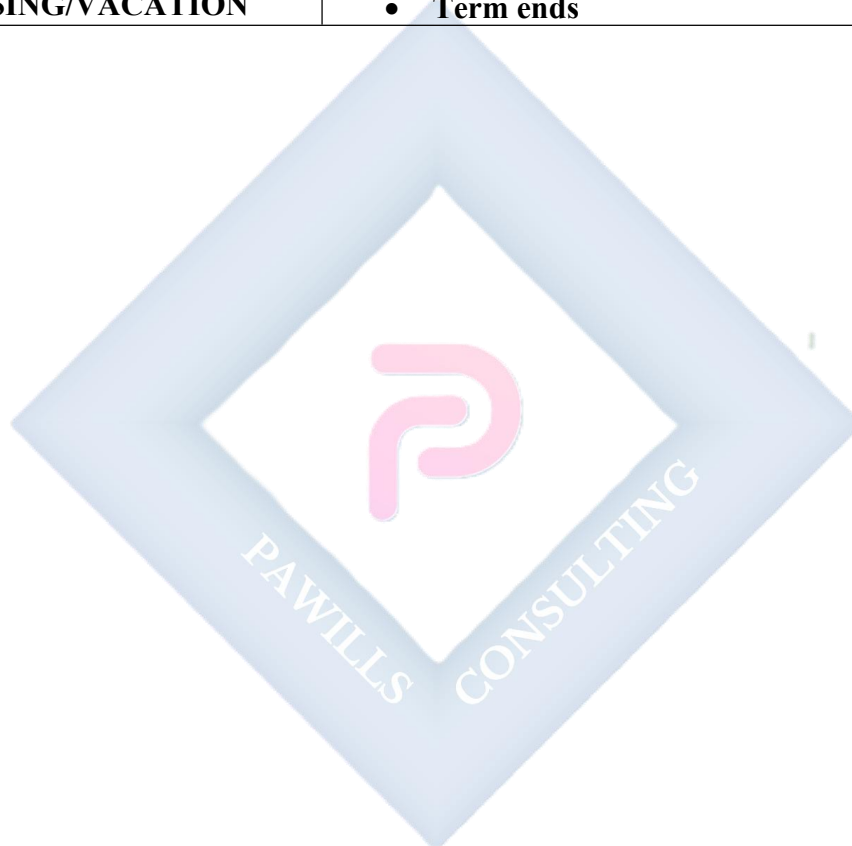
PRIMARY 4 ENGLISH LANGUAGE SCHEME OF WORK

SECOND TERM

Week	Topic	Breakdown (Subtopics)
1	Using Past, Present and Future Tenses	• Understanding the three main tenses • Past tense: actions that already happened • Examples: "I ate yesterday", "She went to school" • Present tense: actions happening now or regularly • Examples: "I eat rice everyday", "He plays football" • Future tense: actions that will happen • Examples: "I will eat salad tomorrow", "We shall visit grandma" • Practice: Converting sentences between tenses
2	Nouns and Pronouns	• Identification of nouns: naming words (people, places, things, ideas) • Types of nouns: common, proper, collective, abstract • Understanding pronouns: words that replace nouns • Types of pronouns: personal (I, you, he, she, it, we, they), possessive (mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs) • Use of nouns and pronouns in sentences • Agreement between nouns and pronouns
3	Adjectives and Adverbs (Part 1)	• Meaning of adjectives: words that describe nouns • Types of adjectives: • Quantitative adjectives (describe quantity): many, few, some • Qualitative adjectives (describe quality): beautiful, tall, kind • Demonstrative adjectives: this, that, these, those • Interrogative adjectives: which, what, whose • Possessive adjectives: my, your, his, her, our, their • Using adjectives to enhance descriptions
4	Adjectives and Adverbs (Part 2)	• Comparative forms of adjectives • Examples: "Janelle is taller than her friend", "Bimpe is more intelligent than Ola" • Order of adjectives: opinion-size-age-shape-color-origin-material-purpose • Meaning of adverbs: words that describe verbs,

		adjectives, or other adverbs • Types of adverbs: manner, time, place, frequency, degree • Comparative forms of adverbs: "Ahmed walks more slowly than Eze" • Use of adjectives and adverbs in sentences
5	MID-TERM EXAMINATION	• Assessment of Weeks 1-4
6	MID-TERM BREAK	• Holiday/Rest
7	Vocabulary: Common Idioms	• Understanding idioms: expressions with meanings different from literal words • Common idioms and their meanings: • "A piece of cake" (very easy) • "Break a leg" (good luck) • "Hit the nail on the head" (exactly right) • "Cost an arm and a leg" (very expensive) • "Once in a blue moon" (very rarely) • Using idioms in sentences • Creating dialogues with idioms
8	Sense Relations: Synonyms and Antonyms	• Meaning of synonyms: words with similar meanings • Examples: happy/joyful, big/large, smart/intelligent, begin/start • Using synonyms to improve vocabulary • Meaning of antonyms: words with opposite meanings • Examples: hot/cold, happy/sad, big/small, fast/slow • Using synonyms and antonyms in sentences • Word games with synonyms and antonyms
9	Sense Relations: Homonyms and Hyponyms	• Meaning of homonyms: words that sound alike or are spelled alike but have different meanings • Examples: bank, bat, spring (as covered in homographs/homophones) • Meaning of hyponyms: specific words under a general category • Examples: Rose, lily, tulip are hyponyms of "flower" • Cat, dog, cow are hyponyms of "animal" • Using sense relations to expand vocabulary • Classification exercises
10	Vocabulary Associated with Various Fields (Part 1)	• Family vocabulary: nuclear family, extended family, father, mother, sister, brothers, nieces, nephews, cousins, grandfather, grandmother,

		mother-in-law, step-mother, etc. • School vocabulary: uniform, library, lessons, exams, school bag, playground, assembly, sports, writing, etc. • Sports vocabulary: team, coach, player, goal, score, win, brace, lose, draw, game, referee, kick, etc. • Using context-specific vocabulary in sentences
11	REVISION	• Review: Tenses, nouns, pronouns, adjectives, adverbs, vocabulary, sense relations
12	EXAMINATION	• End of Term Assessment
13	CLOSING/VACATION	• Term ends



PRIMARY 4 ENGLISH LANGUAGE LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

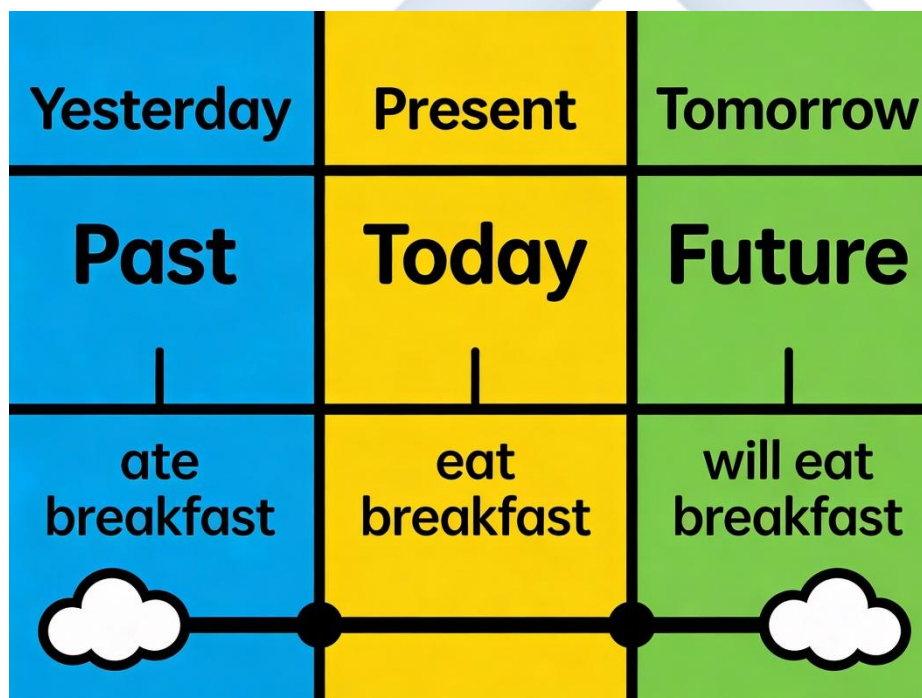
WEEK 1: USING PAST, PRESENT, AND FUTURE TENSES

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define tense as the time an action takes place.
2. Identify the three main tenses: Past, Present, and Future.
3. Construct simple sentences using the Past, Present, and Future tenses.
4. Convert a given sentence from one tense to another.

CONTENT



Yesterday	Present	Tomorrow
Past	Today	Future
ate breakfast	eat breakfast	will eat breakfast

Understanding Tenses

Tenses tell us **when** an action happens. They show time. There are three main times:

1. Present Tense (Now / Regularly)

This talks about actions happening right now or things that happen regularly (habits).

- *Keywords:* Now, Today, Every day, Always.
- *Examples:*
 - I **eat** breakfast every day. (Habit)
 - She **reads** a book now. (Action now)
 - The sun **is** bright. (Fact)

2. Past Tense (Already Happened)

This talks about actions that are finished. They happened before now, like yesterday or last week. We often add "-ed" or change the verb.

- *Keywords:* Yesterday, Last week, Ago, Before.
- *Examples:*
 - I **ate** rice yesterday. (Eat -> Ate)
 - She **played** football last Saturday. (Play -> Played)
 - They **were** happy.

3. Future Tense (Will Happen)

This talks about actions that have not happened yet. They will happen later, like tomorrow or next year. We use "will" or "shall" before the main verb.

- *Keywords:* Tomorrow, Next week, Soon, Later.
- *Examples:*
 - I **will visit** my uncle tomorrow.
 - We **shall go** to the market next week.
 - It **will rain** soon.

Changing Sentences Through Time: Let's follow the action "jump" through time.

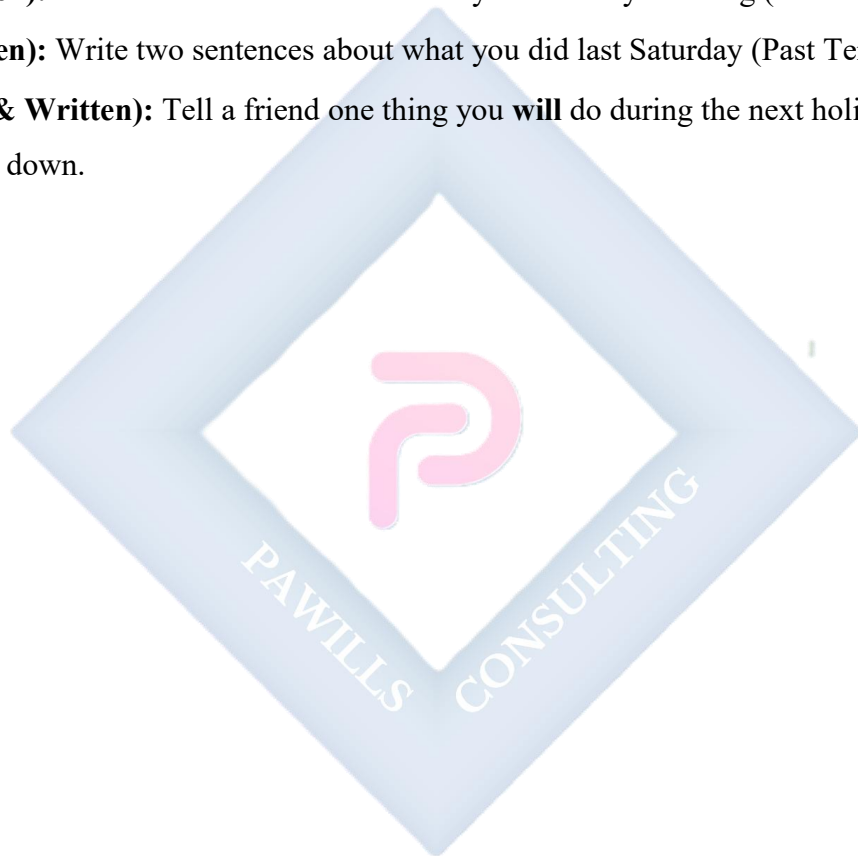
- **Present:** I **jump** over the small stick. (Now/I usually do it)
- **Past:** I **jumped** over the small stick. (I already did it)
- **Future:** I **will jump** over the small stick. (I plan to do it later)

EVALUATION

1. What do tenses show us? (The time of an action).
2. Change to Past Tense: "I walk to school." (I walked to school).
3. Change to Future Tense: "He eats food." (He will eat food).
4. Identify the tense: "We played football yesterday." (Past Tense).
5. What is the past tense of the verb "go"? (Went).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Write two sentences about what you do every morning (Present Tense).
2. **(Written):** Write two sentences about what you did last Saturday (Past Tense).
3. **(Oral & Written):** Tell a friend one thing you **will** do during the next holiday. Then write it down.



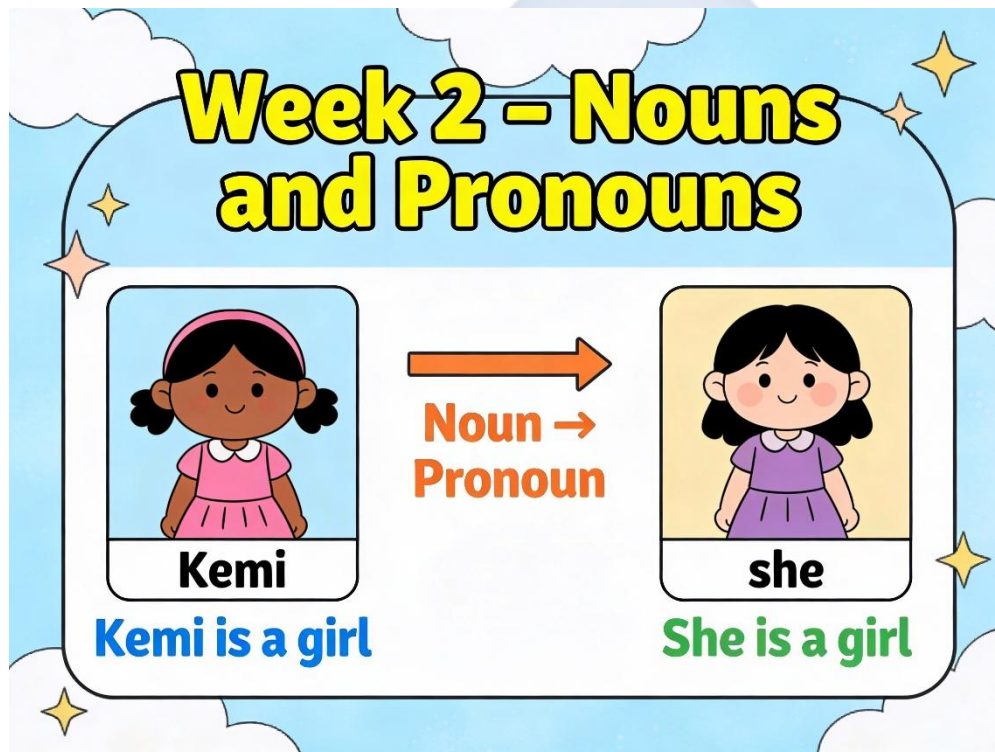
WEEK 2: NOUNS AND PRONOUNS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define a Noun and list examples.
2. Identify four types of nouns (Common, Proper, Collective, Abstract).
3. Define a Pronoun.
4. Use pronouns to replace nouns in sentences.

CONTENT



Nouns A Noun is a **naming word**. It names a person, animal, place, thing, or idea.

- *Examples:* Bola (person), Lagos (place), dog (animal), table (thing), happiness (idea).

Four Types of Nouns:

1. **Common Noun:** General names for people, places, or things. They do not start with a capital letter unless at the start of a sentence.
 - *Examples:* girl, city, school, car, book.

2. **Proper Noun:** Specific names of particular people, places, or things. They **always start with a Capital Letter**.

○ *Examples:* Amina, Nigeria, Ajose Street, Samsung.

3. **Collective Noun:** A name for a **group** of people, animals, or things.

○ *Examples:* a **class** of pupils, a **herd** of cattle, a **bunch** of keys.

4. **Abstract Noun:** Names of things we **cannot see or touch**, but we can feel, think, or imagine. They are ideas, qualities, or feelings.

○ *Examples:* love, bravery, honesty, fear, joy.

Pronouns A Pronoun is a word used **instead of a noun** to avoid repeating the noun. It makes our speaking and writing smoother.

- *Without Pronoun:* **Kemi** is a girl. **Kemi** is kind. **Kemi** likes reading.
- *With Pronoun:* **Kemi** is a girl. **She** is kind. **She** likes reading. ('She' replaces 'Kemi').

Common Pronouns:

- **Personal Pronouns:** I, you, he, she, it, we, they.
- **Possessive Pronouns:** mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs. (They show ownership).
 - "This bag is **mine**." "That book is **hers**."

Agreement (Matching): The pronoun must match the noun it replaces.

- **One person (singular):** Bola is here. **She** (not 'they') is here.
- **Many people (plural):** The **boys** are here. **They** (not 'he') are here.

EVALUATION

1. What is a noun? (A naming word).
2. Give two examples of Proper Nouns from your school.
3. What do we call a group of lions? (A pride of lions - collective noun).
4. Replace the underlined word: "**The man** is tall." (**He** is tall.)
5. "This pencil is (my/mine)." Choose the correct possessive pronoun. (Mine).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Look around your classroom. List two Common Nouns and two Proper Nouns you see.
2. **(Written):** Write two sentences using Abstract Nouns (e.g., "Honesty is good.").
3. **(Oral & Written):** Rewrite this passage using pronouns: "Tunde has a ball. Tunde kicks the ball. The ball is Tunde's."



WEEK 3: ADJECTIVES AND ADVERBS (PART 1)

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define an Adjective.
2. Identify adjectives in a sentence.
3. List and use different types of adjectives (Quantitative, Qualitative, Demonstrative, etc.).
4. Describe objects using appropriate adjectives.

CONTENT



Meaning of Adjectives

An Adjective is a **describing word**. It tells us more about a noun (a person, place, animal, or thing). It adds details like colour, size, number, or quality.

- *Example:* A **tall** man. ('Tall' describes the man).

Types of Adjectives

Type	What it does	Examples
Qualitative	Describes the quality (how something is).	pretty girl, strong man, sweet mango, kind heart
Quantitative	Describes the quantity (how many or how much).	three books, many people, some water, little sugar
Demonstrative	Points to a specific noun.	this chair (here), that tree (there), these pens, those cars
Interrogative	Used to ask questions about a noun.	Which bag? Whose shoe? What colour?
Possessive	Shows who owns something.	my teacher, your house, her dress, our country

Using Adjectives Adjectives usually come before the noun they describe.

- *Without adjective:* I see a house.
- *With adjectives:* I see a **big white** house. (Now we know more about the house).

EVALUATION

1. What is an adjective? (A describing word).
2. Identify the adjective: "She bought a **red** dress."
3. Use a demonstrative adjective to point to a book on the teacher's table. (This book).
4. Mention one adjective that describes quantity.
5. Fill in the blank: "Is this _____ pencil?" (Possessive adjective: your).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written & Drawing):** Draw your favourite fruit. Write three adjectives to describe it (e.g., round, juicy, sweet).
2. **(Written):** Underline the adjectives in these sentences:
 - The old man told a funny story.
 - I have five new pencils.

- That tall building is in Lagos.
3. **(Oral Game):** Play "I Spy" with a partner using adjectives. E.g., "I spy something **green** and **rectangular**." (The board).



WEEK 4: ADJECTIVES AND ADVERBS (PART 2)

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Form comparative adjectives to compare two things.
2. Arrange multiple adjectives in the correct order.
3. Define an Adverb.
4. Identify types of adverbs (Manner, Time, Place).
5. Use adjectives and adverbs correctly in sentences.

CONTENT



Comparing Two Things (Comparative Adjectives)

When we compare two things, we often change the adjective.

- For short adjectives (1-2 syllables), add **-er**.
 - tall -> taller, fast -> faster, big -> bigger.
 - "Emeka is taller than Chinedu."

- For long adjectives, use **more** before the adjective.
 - beautiful -> **more** beautiful, intelligent -> **more** intelligent.
 - "This story is **more** interesting than that one."

Order of Adjectives When we use many adjectives before one noun, there is a sensible order (like putting on clothes: underwear first, then shirt, then jacket). A good order is: **Opinion-Size-Age-Shape-Colour**.

- *Example:* A **lovely** (opinion) **small** (size) **old** (age) **round** (shape) **brown** (colour) table.

Introducing Adverbs An Adverb is a word that describes a **verb** (an action). It tells us **how**, **when**, or **where** an action happens. Many adverbs end with **-ly**.

- *Example:* She runs **quickly**. ('Quickly' describes *how* she runs).

Types of Adverbs:

1. **Adverb of Manner (How):** Describes the way an action is done.
 - *Examples:* slowly, happily, neatly, loudly.
 - *Sentence:* He writes **neatly**.
2. **Adverb of Time (When):** Describes when an action happens.
 - *Examples:* yesterday, now, soon, later, early.
 - *Sentence:* I will come **later**.
3. **Adverb of Place (Where):** Describes where an action happens.
 - *Examples:* here, there, inside, outside, everywhere.
 - *Sentence:* Stand **here**.

EVALUATION

1. What is the comparative form of "cold"? (Colder).
2. What is the comparative form of "expensive"? (More expensive).
3. Arrange these adjectives: (green, big, plastic) bottle. -> (Big green plastic bottle).
4. What is an adverb? (A word that describes a verb).
5. Identify the adverb: "The children played outside." (Outside - adverb of place).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Compare yourself and a friend using two comparative adjectives. E.g., "I am taller, but he is more playful."
2. **(Written):** Write three sentences using adverbs of manner (happily, quietly, quickly).
3. **(Practical):** Describe an object in your home (e.g., a cup) using at least three adjectives in a good order. Tell the class.



WEEK 5: MID-TERM EXAMINATION

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Attempt questions covering topics from Week 1 to Week 4 correctly.

CONTENT

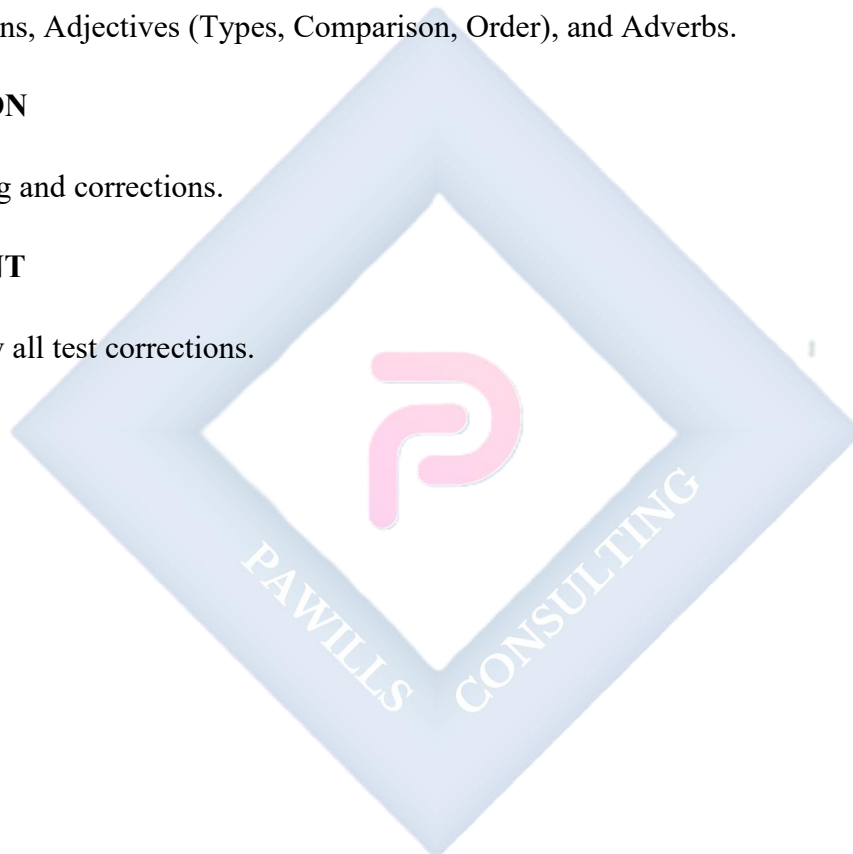
- **Assessment:** The teacher will administer a written test covering Tenses, Nouns, Pronouns, Adjectives (Types, Comparison, Order), and Adverbs.

EVALUATION

- Grading and corrections.

ASSIGNMENT

- Review all test corrections.



WEEK 6: MID-TERM BREAK



WEEK 7: VOCABULARY: COMMON IDIOMS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define an idiom.
2. Explain the meaning of at least five common idioms.
3. Use these idioms in simple sentences.
4. Differentiate between literal meaning and idiomatic meaning.

CONTENT

It's raining cats and dogs



Literal Interpretation:
Cats and dogs
falling from the sky



Actual Meaning:
Heavy rainfall

What is an Idiom? An idiom is a group of words whose meaning is **different from the ordinary meaning** of the individual words. You cannot understand it by looking at the words alone; you must learn the special meaning. It's like a secret code in English.

- *Literal Meaning (Ordinary)*: The basic meaning of the words.
- *Idiomatic Meaning (Special)*: The real meaning of the phrase.

Common Idioms:

Idiom	Literal Meaning (Funny Picture)	Real Meaning (What it means)	Example Sentence
A piece of cake	A slice of cake you eat.	Very easy.	"The quiz was a piece of cake ."
Break a leg	To snap your leg bone.	Good luck! (Said before a performance).	" Break a leg in your debate!"
Cost an arm and a leg	Paying with body parts.	Very expensive.	"That phone costs an arm and a leg ."
Once in a blue moon	When the moon turns blue.	Very rarely; almost never.	"He visits once in a blue moon ."
It's raining cats and dogs	Animals falling from the sky.	Raining very heavily.	"Take an umbrella; it's raining cats and dogs! "

EVALUATION

1. What is an idiom? (A phrase with a special meaning different from its words).
2. What does "a piece of cake" mean?
3. If a toy costs an arm and a leg, is it cheap or expensive?
4. When would you tell someone to "break a leg"?
5. Make a sentence with "once in a blue moon."

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written)**: Draw a funny picture of the **literal** meaning of "it's raining cats and dogs." Write the **real meaning** below.
2. **(Oral)**: Ask an elder at home if they know the idiom "let the cat out of the bag." Try to learn its meaning and share it.
3. **(Written)**: Write about a task that was "a piece of cake" for you.



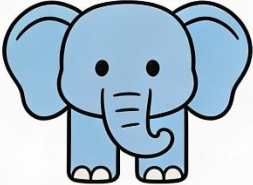
WEEK 8: SENSE RELATIONS: SYNONYMS AND ANTONYMS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define Synonyms and provide examples.
2. Define Antonyms and provide examples.
3. Replace words in a sentence with their synonyms.
4. Replace words in a sentence with their antonyms.

CONTENT

Antonyms		
hot-cold	big-small	happy-sad
		
		

Synonyms (Words that are Friends)

Synonyms are words that have the **same or very similar meanings**. We use them to avoid repeating the same word and to make our writing richer.

- **Big** = Large, Huge
- **Happy** = Joyful, Glad
- **Small** = Tiny, Little

- **Smart** = Intelligent, Clever
- *Example:* "It was a **big** house." -> "It was a **huge** house."

Antonyms (Words that are Opposites) Antonyms are words that have **opposite meanings**.

- **Hot** <-> Cold
- **Day** <-> Night
- **Fast** <-> Slow
- **Tall** <-> Short
- **Up** <-> Down
- *Example:* "The soup is **hot**." -> "The soup is **cold**."

Word Relationship Chart:

Word	Synonym (Friend)	Antonym (Opposite)
Begin	Start	End, Finish
Brave	Courageous	Cowardly, Scared
Easy	Simple	Difficult, Hard

EVALUATION

1. What are synonyms? (Words with similar meanings).
2. Give a synonym for "quick." (Fast).
3. What are antonyms? (Words with opposite meanings).
4. Give the antonym of "empty." (Full).
5. Replace the underlined word with a synonym: "She gave a **gift** to her mother." (Present).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Find a synonym and an antonym for: **happy**, **close** (verb), **light** (weight).
2. **(Oral Game):** Play "Opposite Race" with a friend. One says a word, the other says its antonym as fast as they can.

3. **(Written):** Rewrite this sentence by changing the adjectives to their antonyms: "The **rich** man lived in a **huge** house." (The poor man lived in a tiny house.)



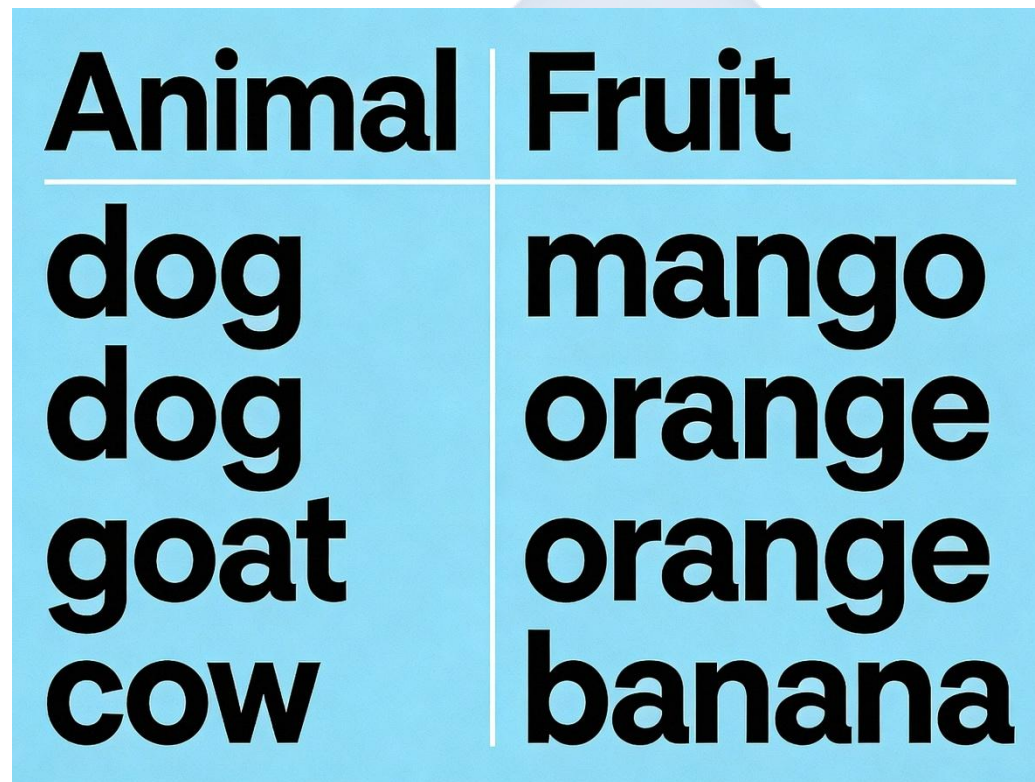
WEEK 9: SENSE RELATIONS: HOMONYMS AND HYPONYMS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define Homonyms.
2. Identify homonyms and their different meanings.
3. Define Hyponyms (general and specific terms).
4. Classify words under their correct general categories.

CONTENT



Animal	Fruit
dog	mango
dog	orange
goat	orange
cow	banana

Homonyms

Homonyms are words that are **spelled the same OR sound the same** but have **different meanings**. This includes homophones (sound same) and homographs (spell same).

- **Example (Sound & Spell same):**
 - **Bat:** 1. A flying animal. 2. A sports stick.

- **Match:** 1. A game (football match). 2. A stick to make fire.

Hyponyms (The "Family" of Words) Hyponyms are specific words that belong to a general group or family. The general word is called the **superordinate**.

- Think of it like a family tree. "Fruit" is the general parent. "Mango," "Orange," and "Banana" are its specific children (hyponyms).

Examples of Categories and Hyponyms:

General Category (Superordinate)	Specific Members (Hyponyms)
Colour	red, blue, yellow, green, black
Furniture	chair, table, bed, cupboard
Vehicle	car, bus, bicycle, lorry, kite
Subject	English, Mathematics, Science, Social Studies

EVALUATION

1. Give two meanings for the word "match."
2. Use "ring" in two sentences showing different meanings.
3. What is the general name for "English, Maths, Science"? (School subjects).
4. List three hyponyms for "Clothing" (e.g., shirt, trouser, cap).
5. Is "goat" a hyponym of "animal"? (Yes/No).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Drawing):** Draw two small pictures to show the different meanings of "foot" (body part) and "foot" (measurement).
2. **(Written):** List four hyponyms for the category "Drinks."
3. **(Classification):** Sort these words into two general categories: [*Teacher, Lion, Doctor, Cat, Nurse, Elephant*]. Categories: **Professions** and **Animals**.

WEEK 10: VOCABULARY ASSOCIATED WITH VARIOUS FIELDS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify words related to the Family.
2. Identify words related to School.
3. Identify words related to Sports.
4. Use these words correctly in sentences.

CONTENT



1. Family Vocabulary

- **Nuclear Family:** Father, Mother, Children.
- **Extended Family:** Grandparents, Uncles, Aunts, Cousins.
- **Siblings:** Your brothers and sisters.
- **Nephew:** The son of your brother or sister.
- **Niece:** The daughter of your brother or sister.
- **In-laws:** Relatives through marriage (e.g., brother-in-law).

2. School Vocabulary

- **Headteacher/Principal:** The leader of the school.
- **Class Teacher:** The teacher in charge of your class.
- **Prefect:** A pupil with special responsibilities.
- **Assembly:** A gathering of all pupils for announcements or prayers.
- **Library:** A room or building where books are kept for reading.
- **Curriculum:** All the subjects and activities taught in school.
- **Timetable:** A schedule showing when subjects are taught.

3. Sports Vocabulary

- **Referee/Umpire:** The person who enforces the rules during a game.
- **Coach:** The person who trains a team or athlete.
- **Team:** A group of players on one side.
- **Spectators:** People who come to watch a game.
- **Pitch/Field/Court:** The area where a sport is played.
- **Goal:** (In football) To score a point; the structure where the ball enters.

EVALUATION

1. Who is your niece? (Your brother's or sister's daughter).
2. What do we call the person who leads a primary school? (Headteacher).
3. Who blows the whistle in a football match? (The referee).
4. What is a library used for? (Reading and borrowing books).
5. Mention two members of your extended family.

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Drawing):** Draw a simple family tree showing your immediate family (parents and siblings).
2. **(Practical):** List five items you find in your school bag.

3. **(Written):** Write three sentences about your favourite sport, using at least two of the new sports words.



WEEK 11: REVISION

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Recall key concepts taught from Week 1 to Week 10.
2. Answer questions on Tenses, Nouns, Adjectives, Idioms, and Vocabulary.

CONTENT

Comprehensive Review

- **Grammar:** Present, Past, Future Tenses. Common vs. Proper Nouns. Using Adjectives and Adverbs.
- **Vocabulary:** Idioms (e.g., piece of cake). Synonyms/Antonyms. Family, School, and Sports words.

EVALUATION

- Oral quizzes and written revision exercises covering the term's work.

ASSIGNMENT

- Study all notes for the end-of-term examination.
-

PRIMARY 4 ENGLISH LANGUAGE SCHEME OF WORK

THIRD TERM

Week	Topic	Breakdown (Subtopics)
1	Introduction to Stress	• Meaning of stress: emphasis placed on syllables or words • Types of stress: Word stress: emphasis on specific syllables (e.g., Table, WRiting, BEAutiful) • Sentence stress: emphasis on certain words for meaning (e.g., "I DIDN'T say he stole it" vs. "I didn't say HE stole it") • Simple stress placement rules for two-syllable words • Practice identifying and marking stressed syllables
2	Introduction to Stress (Continued)	• Stress placement rules: • Two-syllable nouns/adjectives: stress first syllable (Table, HAPpy) • Two-syllable verbs/prepositions: stress second syllable (arRIVE, beGIN) • Compound words: stress patterns (BLACKboard for nouns, overCOME for verbs) • Practice exercises with word and sentence stress • Pronunciation drills emphasizing correct stress
3	Introduction to Intonation	• Meaning of intonation: rise and fall of voice in speaking • Importance of intonation: • Expresses attitudes and emotions • Differentiates questions from statements • Clarifies meaning in sentences • Types of intonation: rising intonation and falling intonation • Practice: "You're coming." (statement) vs. "You're coming?" (question)
4	Dialogue Using Tag Questions	• Meaning of question tags: short questions at the end of statements • Basic rules: positive statement → negative tag • negative statement → positive tag • Positive examples: "Tomorrow is Monday, isn't it?", "You are a boy/girl, aren't you?",

		"She is quite attractive, isn't she?" - Negative examples: "You didn't come to school, did you?", "This book isn't yours, is it?" - Creating dialogues with tag questions - Practice conversations
5	MID-TERM EXAMINATION	Assessment of Weeks 1-4
6	MID-TERM BREAK	Holiday/Rest
7	Oral Composition: Narrative Composition	- Narration on various topics: "A Visit to My Village" "My First Day at School" "A Visit to the Market" - Elements of narrative: beginning, middle, end - characters, setting, events - Practice oral storytelling - Group narration activities - Recording or presenting narratives to class
8	Oral Composition: Descriptive Composition	- Description of places, people, events - Using descriptive words: adjectives, sensory details - Practice describing: - A person (appearance, personality) - A place (school, market, village) - An event (birthday party, festival) - Oral presentations of descriptions - Peer feedback and improvement
9	Reading Comprehension: Using Contextual Clues	- Reading passages on various issues: - Taxation, achieving academic excellence - Skill acquisition, building good character/manners - Using contextual clues to get meanings of unfamiliar words - Literal, inferential, and critical questions on passages - Using unfamiliar words in sentences - Vocabulary building through context
10	Reading Comprehension: Main and Supporting Ideas	- Reading class-appropriate informational texts on: - Diet and nutrition, benefits of eating for healthy living - Pollution: types, causes, and purification - Charitable donations: importance of giving money to those in need

		- Identifying main ideas (what the passage is mostly about) - Identifying supporting ideas (details that support the main idea) - Practice summarizing passages
11	REVISION	Review: Stress, intonation, tag questions, oral composition, comprehension
12	EXAMINATION	End of Term Assessment (Written and Oral)
13	CLOSING/VACATION	Term ends



PRIMARY 4 ENGLISH LANGUAGE LESSON NOTES

THIRD TERM

WEEK 1: INTRODUCTION TO STRESS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define stress as the emphasis placed on syllables or words.
2. Differentiate between word stress and sentence stress.
3. Identify the stressed syllable in simple two-syllable words.
4. Pronounce words correctly by placing stress on the right syllable.

CONTENT

Word Stress Chart

TA-ble

PEN-cil

WA-ter

Meaning of Stress in Speaking

In English, stress is the **extra force or emphasis** we put on one part of a word or on one word in a sentence when we speak. It is like saying one part **louder, longer, and slightly higher** than the rest.

- It is **not** about feeling worried. It is about pronunciation.

Syllables: The Beats in a Word A syllable is a single sound beat in a word. We can clap for each syllable.

- Tea-cher (2 claps: **Tea**-cher)
- Pen-cil (2 claps: **Pen**-cil)
- Fa-ther (2 claps: **Fa**-ther)

Types of Stress

1. **Word Stress:** This means stressing one syllable inside a word. Every word with more than one syllable has a stressed syllable.
 - **TA-ble** (Stress on **TA**)
 - **BEAU-ti-ful** (Stress on **BEAU**)
 - **re-MEM-ber** (Stress on **MEM**)
2. **Sentence Stress:** This means stressing certain **words** in a sentence to show their importance or to change the meaning.
 - "I love jollof rice." (Emphasis on *I* means *I* am the one, not you).
 - "I **LOVE** jollof rice." (Emphasis on *love* shows strong feeling).

Simple Rule for Two-Syllable Words For many simple two-syllable words, especially nouns, we stress the **FIRST** syllable.

- **PEN**-cil, **TA**-ble, **WA**-ter, **MO**-ney.

EVALUATION

1. What is stress in speaking? (Saying part of a word or a word louder and longer).
2. How do we say a stressed syllable? (Louder, longer, higher).
3. Clap the syllables in "mother." How many? (Two: **Moth**-er).
4. Where is the stress in "**BA**-by"? (First syllable).
5. Say "**SHE** gave me the book." What word is stressed? What does it emphasise? (SHE - meaning *she* did it, not someone else).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Practical):** Clap and say the syllables in: sister, Monday, happy. Underline the stressed part.
2. **(Written):** Write the words DOCTOR and BASKET. Capitalize the stressed syllable (e.g., **DOC**-tor).
3. **(Oral):** Say the sentence "I am reading" three times, stressing a different word each time: **I** am reading / I **AM** reading / I am **READING**. Notice how the feeling changes.



WEEK 2: INTRODUCTION TO STRESS (CONTINUED)

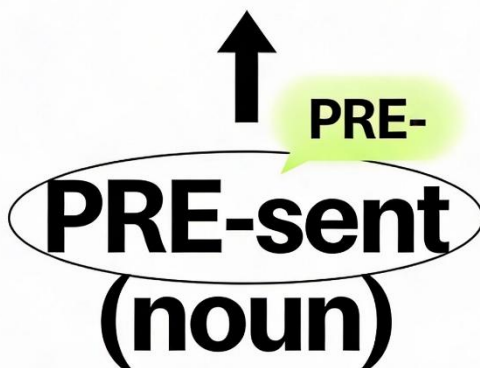
OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. State the stress rule for two-syllable nouns and adjectives.
2. State the stress rule for two-syllable verbs.
3. Identify stress patterns in compound words.
4. Pronounce words correctly according to their parts of speech.

CONTENT

Noun and Verb Stress Comparison



↑ PRE-
PRE-sent
(noun)



↑ SENT
pre-**SENT**
(verb)

Stress Rules for Different Word Types

Rule 1: Nouns and Adjectives

For most two-syllable **Nouns** (naming words) and **Adjectives** (describing words), stress the **FIRST** syllable.

- **Nouns:** TEA-cher, WIN-dow, PEN-cil.

- **Adjectives:** HAP-py, SIL-ly, CLE-ver.

Rule 2: Verbs For many two-syllable **Verbs** (action words), stress the **SECOND** syllable.

- **Verbs:** be-GIN, for-GET, pre-SENT (to give), re-LAX.

Words that Change Stress Some words change their meaning when the stress moves! They can be a noun or a verb.

- **PRE-sent** (Noun): A gift. "I have a **PRE-sent** for you."
- **pre-SENT** (Verb): To show or give. "I will **pre-SENT** my work."

Rule 3: Compound Words A compound word is made by joining two words together.

- **Compound Nouns:** Stress the **FIRST** part.
 - FOOTball, CLASSroom, BIRTHday.
- **Compound Verbs/Adjectives:** Often stress the **SECOND** part.
 - under-STAND, over-FLOW, well-KNOWN.

Pronunciation Drill Table:

Word	Part of Speech	Stress	Example Sentence
RE -cord	Noun (Thing)	First	Keep a RE -cord of your marks.
re- CORD	Verb (Action)	Second	Please re- CORD your voice.
OB -ject	Noun (Thing)	First	That is a strange OB -ject.
ob- JECT	Verb (Action)	Second	I ob- JECT to that idea.

EVALUATION

1. Where is the stress in two-syllable nouns like "pencil"? (First syllable).
2. Where is the stress in two-syllable verbs like "forget"? (Second syllable).
3. Pronounce "export" as a noun and as a verb.
4. Where is the stress in the compound word "blackboard"? (First part: **BLACK**board).
5. Mark the stress in "between." (be-**TWEEN**).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Sorting):** Sort these words by their stressed syllable: (*Simple, Decide, Happy, Relax*).
First Syllable: _____. Second Syllable: _____.
2. **(Written):** Write two compound nouns you know and underline the stressed part.
3. **(Oral):** Use "project" in two sentences: once as a noun (**PRO**-ject) and once as a verb (pro-**JECT**).



WEEK 3: INTRODUCTION TO INTONATION

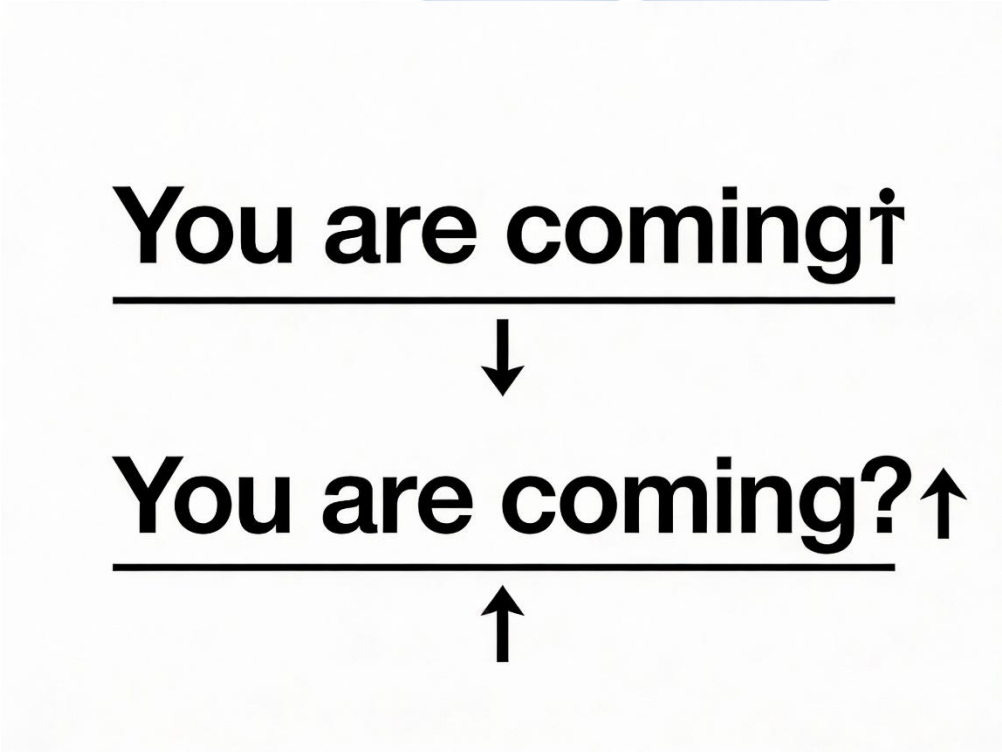
OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define intonation.
2. Differentiate between Rising and Falling Intonation.
3. Use falling intonation for statements.
4. Use rising intonation for Yes/No questions.

CONTENT

Meaning of Intonation



You are coming↓

The diagram illustrates falling intonation for a statement. It features a light blue background with a large white arrow pointing downwards from the text 'You are coming' to the text 'You are coming?'. The text 'You are coming' is underlined, and a small downward-pointing arrow is positioned below the underline.

You are coming?↑

The diagram illustrates rising intonation for a question. It features a light blue background with a large white arrow pointing upwards from the text 'You are coming?' to the text 'You are coming?'. The text 'You are coming?' is underlined, and a small upward-pointing arrow is positioned below the underline.

Intonation is the **rise and fall of our voice** when we speak. It is like the music or melody of our speech. Without intonation, we would sound like robots.

Why Intonation is Important:

1. It shows our feelings (happy, sad, surprised, angry).

2. It tells the listener if we are making a statement or asking a question.
3. It makes our speech interesting and clear.

The Two Main Patterns:

1. Falling Intonation (Voice goes DOWN ∨)

- Used for:
 - **Statements (giving information):** "My name is Chidi. ∨"
 - **Commands:** "Close the door. ∨"
 - **Wh-Questions** (starting with What, Where, Who, When, Why, How):
"What is your name? ∨"

2. Rising Intonation (Voice goes UP ↗)

- Used for:
 - **Yes/No Questions** (questions answered with Yes or No): "Are you coming? ↗" "Is this your bag? ↗"
 - To show **surprise or doubt:** "Really? ↗" "You did that? ↗"

Practice with the Same Words: The same words can mean different things with different intonation.

- "You are ready. ∨" (This is a statement. I am telling you.)
- "You are ready? ↗" (This is a question. I am asking to confirm.)

EVALUATION

1. What is intonation? (The rise and fall of our voice when speaking).
2. What are the two main types of intonation? (Rising and Falling).
3. "Sit down." - Should I use rising or falling intonation? (Falling ∨ - it's a command).
4. "Are you hungry?" - Should I use rising or falling intonation? (Rising ↗ - it's a Yes/No question).
5. Why is intonation important? (It shows feeling and meaning).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Draw an arrow (↘ or ↗) next to each sentence to show the correct intonation.
a. Where is Lagos? ↘ b. Can I have some water? ↗ c. Today is Monday. ↘
2. **(Oral):** Practice saying these Yes/No questions with rising intonation: "Is it raining?"
"Do you like football?"
3. **(Practical):** Read a short sentence from your storybook to a family member, using clear intonation.



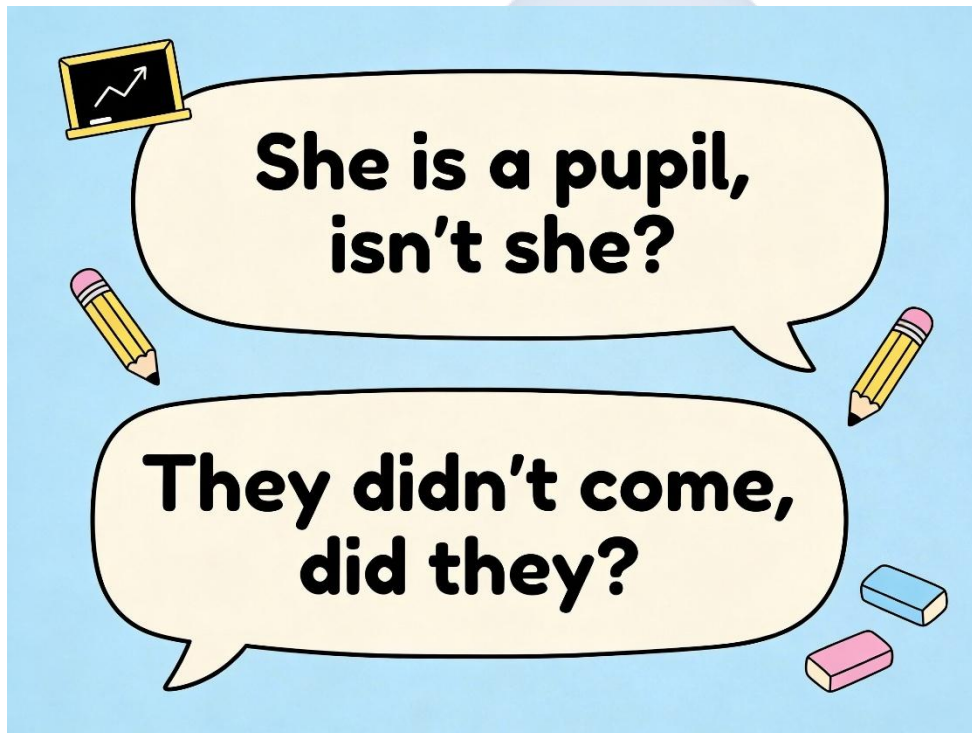
WEEK 4: DIALOGUE USING TAG QUESTIONS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define a question tag.
2. State the basic rules for forming question tags.
3. Add the correct question tag to positive and negative statements.
4. Engage in a simple dialogue using question tags.

CONTENT



Meaning of Question Tags

A question tag is a **short question** added to the end of a statement. We use it to check if something is true, to ask for agreement, or to make conversation.

- *Example:* "It is hot today, **isn't it?**" (You expect the listener to agree: "Yes, it is.")

The Golden Rule: Opposite! The tag is always the **opposite** of the main statement.

1. **Positive Statement (+), Negative Tag (-)**

- "She **is** a pupil, **isn't** she?"
- "You **like** rice, **don't** you?" (We add 'do' for present tense verbs like 'like').

2. Negative Statement (-), Positive Tag (+)

- "He **is not** here, **is** he?"
- "You **didn't** finish, **did** you?"

Common Question Tags:

Statement	Tag	Reason
You are happy,	aren't you?	Positive statement -> negative tag with 'are'
She can swim,	can't she?	Positive -> negative tag with 'can'
We will go,	won't we?	Positive -> negative tag with 'will' (won't = will not)
It isn't cold,	is it?	Negative statement -> positive tag
They don't talk,	do they?	Negative -> positive tag with 'do'

Special Case: I am helpful, **aren't** I? (We say "aren't I?" not "amn't I?").

Practice Dialogue

- **Tunde:** "You enjoy football, **don't** you?"
- **Amina:** "Yes, I do. The match is today, **isn't** it?"
- **Tunde:** "Yes, at 4 pm. We won't be late, **will** we?"

EVALUATION

1. What is a question tag? (A short question at the end of a sentence).
2. Complete: "She is tall, _____?" (isn't she).
3. Complete: "They are not coming, _____?" (are they).
4. Complete: "He can drive, _____?" (can't he).
5. If the statement is negative, the tag must be _____. (Positive).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Add the correct question tags: a. The sky is blue, _____? b. We are not loud, _____? c. She loves singing, _____?
2. **(Oral Dialogue):** With a partner, create a 4-line conversation about the weather using question tags.
3. **(Written):** Complete: "I am your friend, _____?" (aren't I?).



WEEK 5: MID-TERM EXAMINATION

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Attempt questions covering topics from Week 1 to Week 4 correctly.

CONTENT

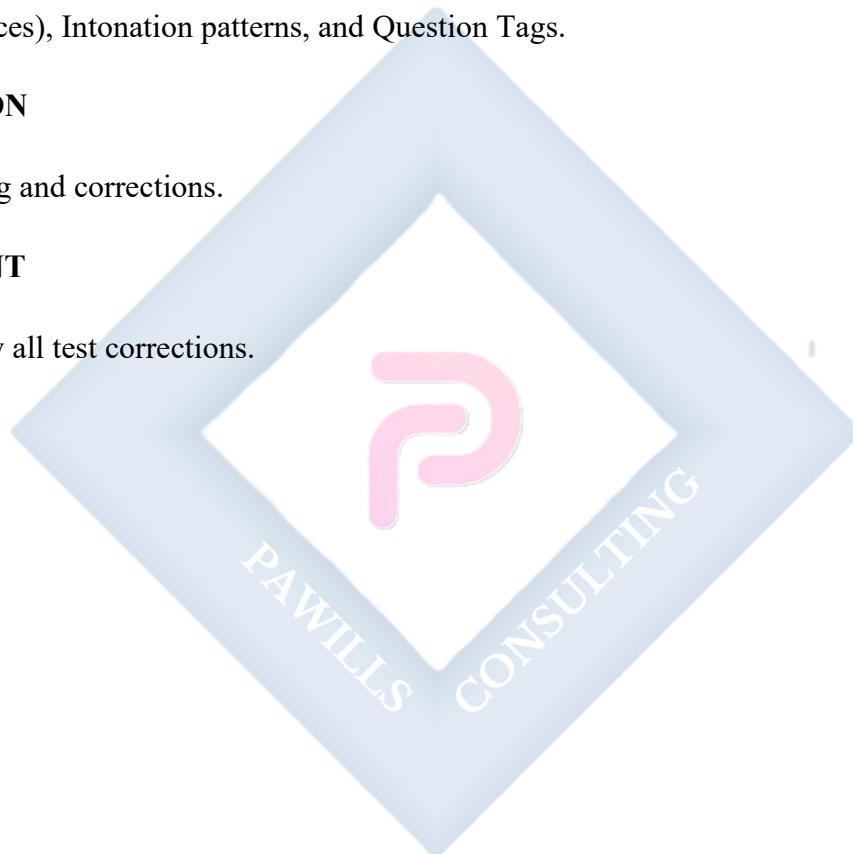
- **Assessment:** The teacher will administer a written test covering Stress (Words and Sentences), Intonation patterns, and Question Tags.

EVALUATION

- Grading and corrections.

ASSIGNMENT

- Review all test corrections.



WEEK 6: MID-TERM BREAK



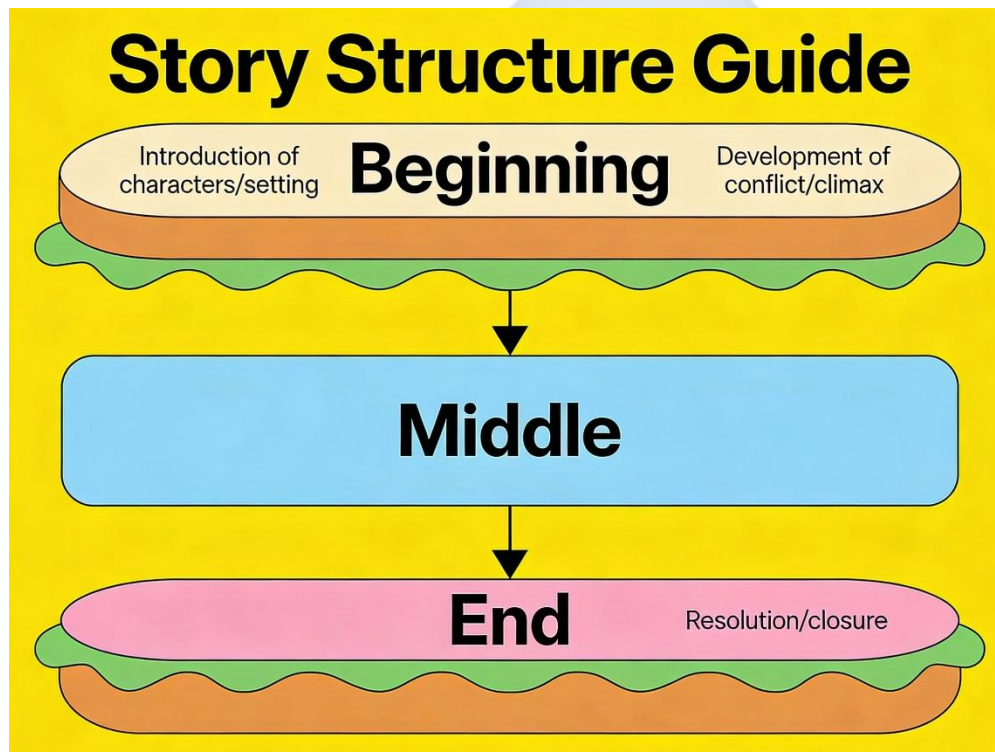
WEEK 7: ORAL COMPOSITION: NARRATIVE COMPOSITION

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define a narrative composition (storytelling).
2. Identify the three main parts of a story (Beginning, Middle, End).
3. Narrate a short story on a given topic clearly.
4. Use connecting words (first, then, next, finally) in speech.

CONTENT



What is a Narrative?

A narrative is simply **telling a story**. It is reporting events in the order they happened. When you tell your mother what happened at school, you are narrating.

Parts of a Good Story (Like a Sandwich)

1. **Beginning (Introduction):** This is like the top slice of bread. It introduces the story.

- *Answer:* **Who?** (Characters), **Where?** (Setting), **When?** (Time).
 - *Example:* "**Last Saturday, I** went to the **market with my mother.**"
2. **Middle (Body):** This is the filling (the main events). It is the longest part.
- *Answer:* **What happened?** (The main actions and events in order).
 - *Example:* "**First**, we bought oranges. **Then**, we saw a puppet show. **Next**, I ate roasted plantain."
3. **End (Conclusion):** This is the bottom slice of bread. It finishes the story.
- *Answer:* **How did it end? How did you feel?**
 - *Example:* "**Finally**, we went home. I felt very happy and tired."

Connecting Words (Story Glue)

Use these words to link your events smoothly:

- **First, Then, Next, After that, Finally.**
- **Yesterday, Later, In the end.**

Practice Activity Pupils will take turns standing up to tell a short story about "**How I came to school this morning**" using the Beginning-Middle-End structure.

EVALUATION

1. What is a narrative? (Telling a story or events in order).
2. What are the three parts of a story? (Beginning, Middle, End).
3. Mention two connecting words used in storytelling.
4. What should you say in the Beginning of a story? (Who, where, when).
5. Why is the order of events important? (So the listener can understand).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Oral Preparation):** Prepare to tell a short story about "**A Day I Helped Someone.**"
You will tell the class next week.
2. **(Written Plan):** On paper, write notes for your story in three sections: Beginning (1 line), Middle (3 events), End (1 line).

3. **(Practical):** Practice telling your story to a mirror or a family member.



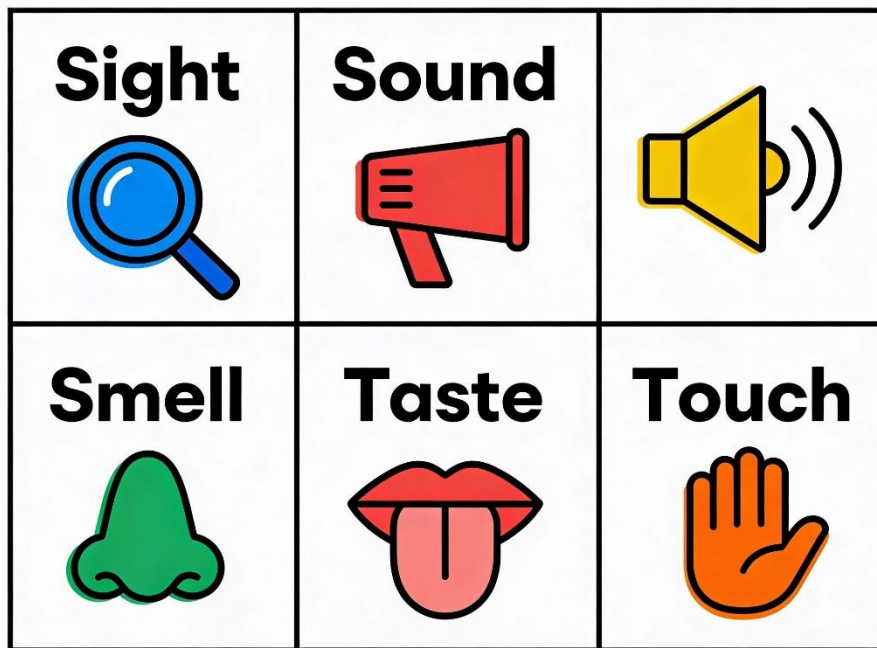
WEEK 8: ORAL COMPOSITION: DESCRIPTIVE COMPOSITION

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define descriptive composition.
2. Use adjectives and sensory words to describe people, places, or events.
3. Describe a person (appearance and character) orally.
4. Describe a place (school or market) orally.

CONTENT



What is Description?

Description means **painting a picture with words**. You use words to explain how something looks, sounds, smells, tastes, or feels so that the listener can see it in their mind.

Using Your Senses to Describe:

- **Sight:** How does it look? (Colour, size, shape) - *red, tall, round*.
- **Sound:** How does it sound? - *noisy, quiet, loud*.

- **Smell:** How does it smell? - *sweet, fresh, stinky*.
- **Taste:** How does it taste? - *sour, sweet, spicy*.
- **Touch/Feel:** How does it feel? - *rough, smooth, hot, cold*.

How to Describe a Person

1. **Introduction:** Say who the person is. "My friend, Uche, is..."
2. **Physical Appearance (Looks):** Talk about height, size, complexion, hair, eyes, clothes.
"He is tall and slim. He has short black hair."
3. **Character/Personality (Behaviour):** Is he kind, funny, smart, shy? "He is very kind and always helps me."
4. **Why you like them:** "I like him because he makes me laugh."

How to Describe a Place (e.g., Your Classroom)

- **Sight:** "It is a **big, bright** room with **yellow** walls."
- **Sound:** "It is usually **quiet** during lessons, but **noisy** during break."
- **Things inside:** "There are **twenty brown** desks and a **large green** board."

Class Activity: "Guess Who?" One pupil describes a classmate without saying the name. Others guess who it is based on the description.

EVALUATION

1. What is descriptive composition? (Using words to create a picture).
2. Mention two words to describe the sound of a marketplace. (Noisy, Loud).
3. When describing a person, what two main things do we talk about? (Appearance and Character).
4. Describe the chalkboard using two adjectives. (e.g., Large, black).
5. What sense do we use to know something is "sweet"? (Taste).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Written):** Write five adjectives to describe your best friend's personality (e.g., kind, funny).

2. **(Drawing & Writing):** Draw your favourite place in the school (e.g., playground, library). Write three sentences describing it.
3. **(Oral):** Prepare a 1-minute description of your **school bag**. Describe its colour, size, what's in it, and how it looks.



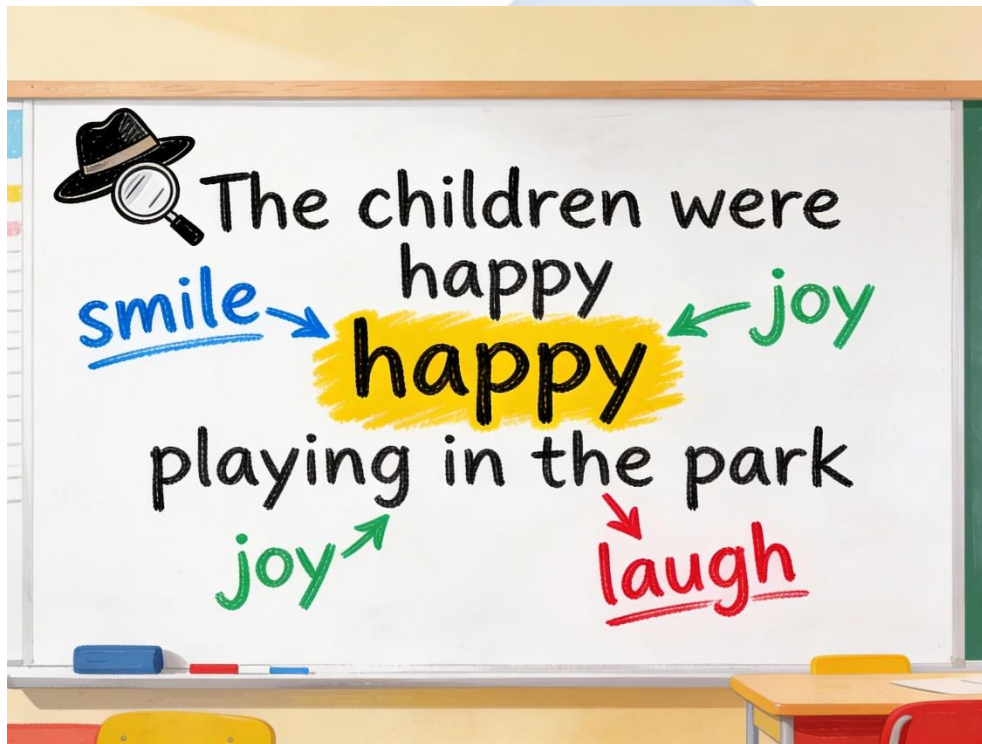
WEEK 9: READING COMPREHENSION: USING CONTEXTUAL CLUES

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Explain what contextual clues are.
2. Read a passage fluently.
3. Guess the meaning of unfamiliar words by looking at the words around them.
4. Answer questions based on the passage correctly.

CONTENT



What are Contextual Clues?

When you are reading and see a difficult word, you don't always need a dictionary. You can use **Context Clues**. This means you look at the **other words in the same sentence or nearby sentences** to guess the meaning. The context (setting of the word) gives you hints.

Example:

- "The classroom was **tidy**. All the books were on the shelf, the floor was clean, and the chairs were in a row."
- *Clue:* The sentence describes everything being neat and in order.
- *Guess:* **Tidy** must mean neat and clean.

Types of Clues:

1. **Example Clue:** The sentence gives examples.
 - "Vehicles like cars, buses, and motorcycles use the road."
2. **Synonym Clue:** A similar word is used nearby.
 - "He felt **joyful**, very happy about his result."

Strategy for Finding Clues:

1. Read the whole sentence containing the hard word.
2. Look for words that explain, describe, or give examples about the hard word.
3. Make a smart guess.
4. Read the sentence again with your guess to see if it makes sense.

Reading Practice Reading a simple passage about "Being a Good Pupil."

- *Sentence:* "A good pupil shows **diligence**. This means they work hard and do not give up easily."
- *Clue:* The next sentence explains it: "work hard and do not give up."
- *Meaning of diligence:* Hard work.

EVALUATION

1. What are contextual clues? (Hints from other words in the sentence).
2. "The ground was **parched** and cracked because it had not rained for months." What does 'parched' mean? (Very dry).
3. "She is **reliable**; you can always count on her to keep a promise." What does 'reliable' mean? (Trustworthy).
4. Why should we look at the words around a difficult word?

5. Answer two simple questions from the passage read in class.

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Reading):** Read a paragraph from your storybook.
2. **(Written):** Find one difficult word. Write down the sentence it is in and what you think it means based on context clues.
3. **(Practical):** Ask an elder to check if your guess was correct.



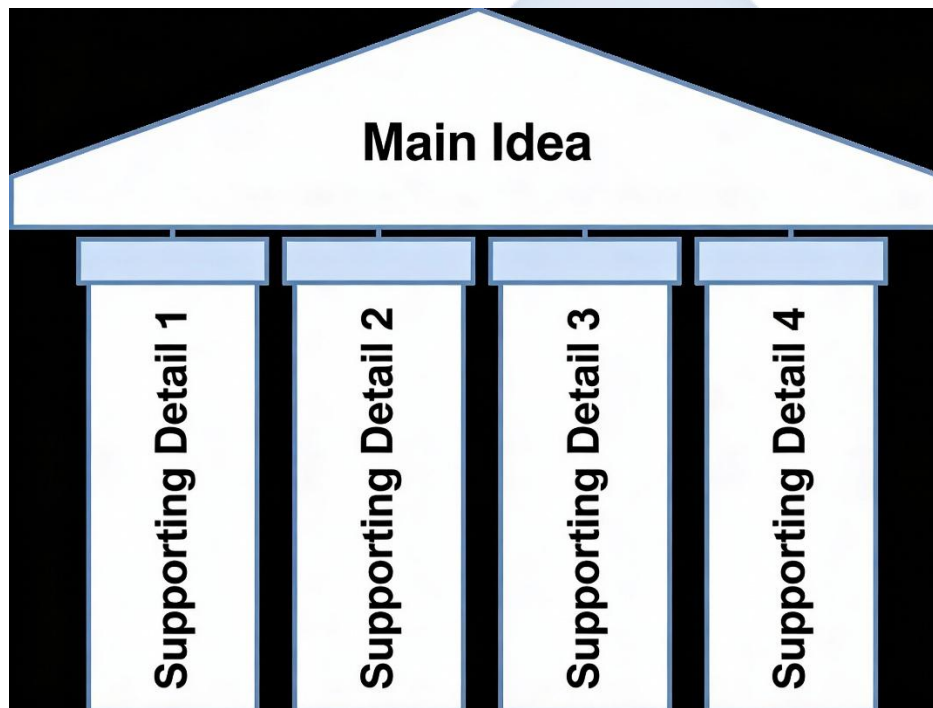
WEEK 10: READING COMPREHENSION: MAIN AND SUPPORTING IDEAS

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define the "Main Idea" of a paragraph.
2. Identify "Supporting Ideas" or details.
3. Read an informational text (Diet, Pollution, or Charity).
4. Summarize the passage in one or two sentences.

CONTENT



Main Idea vs. Supporting Ideas

- **Main Idea:** This is the **most important point** the author wants you to know. It is the big message of the paragraph. It is like the **roof of a house**. It often comes at the beginning or end of a paragraph.
- **Supporting Ideas:** These are the **facts, reasons, or examples** that explain, prove, or give more details about the main idea. They are like the **walls and pillars** that hold up the roof.

Example: A Paragraph About Fruits

- **"Eating fruits is very good for your health.** (Main Idea - the big point). Oranges give you vitamin C. Bananas give you energy. Apples help your digestion. (Supporting Ideas - details explaining *why* they are good)."

Finding the Main Idea: Ask yourself: "What is this paragraph **mostly about**?"

Practice with a Topic: "Pollution" Read a short passage.

- *Task 1:* Find the sentence that tells us what pollution is. (Main Idea).
- *Task 2:* Find sentences that list examples like dirty water, smoke from cars, or litter. (Supporting Details).

Why is this Skill Important? Finding the main idea helps you understand the text quickly and remember the most important information.

EVALUATION

1. What is the Main Idea of a paragraph? (The most important point).
2. What do Supporting Ideas do? (Give details, examples, reasons).
3. Read: "Dogs make great pets. They are loyal friends. They can protect your home. They love to play." What is the main idea? (Dogs make great pets).
4. Give one supporting detail from the text above. (They are loyal friends).
5. Why is it useful to find the main idea? (To understand quickly).

ASSIGNMENT

1. **(Reading):** Read a short article or a paragraph from your Social Studies textbook.
2. **(Written):** Write down the Main Idea in your own words.
3. **(Written):** List two Supporting Details from the text.

WEEK 11: REVISION

OBJECTIVES

By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Recall key concepts taught from Week 1 to Week 10.
2. Answer questions on Stress, Intonation, Tag Questions, Narrative/Descriptive composition, and Comprehension strategies.

CONTENT

Comprehensive Review

- **Oral English:** Word & Sentence Stress, Rising/Falling Intonation.
- **Grammar:** Question Tags (+, - rules).
- **Composition:** Story parts (Beginning, Middle, End), Using descriptive words.
- **Reading:** Using context clues, Finding main ideas.

EVALUATION

- Oral quizzes and written revision exercises covering the term's work.

ASSIGNMENT

- Study all notes for the end-of-term examination.